



CITY: Pg 2

Woman, two daughters killed in house fire at Lodhi Colony



NATION: Pg 5

Oppn leaders visit Jantar Mantar after crackdown, back CJP protest



FILM: Pg 12

'Didn't want to do injustice'

Paper leak protest reaches PM's doorstep

RAHUL, PRIYANKA, AKHILESH FORCIBLY REMOVED AND DETAINED

AAISHA SABIR
VINAY KUMAR

NEW DELHI: It was a day of swift dramatic developments in the country's national politics that unfolded in the national Capital on Tuesday when Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi led a Congress protest against alleged paper leaks and the brutal police action on protesting students to Prime Minister Narendra Modi's residence.

A few hours later, Rahul Gandhi, and other party leaders and MPs were dragged away by the police from outside the PM's residence. "Democracy in India is happening right now," Gandhi told reporters while being carried away by the policemen.

A day after the Cockroach Janta Party-led march to Parliament which was blocked by the police using lathi charge and teargas, Gandhi, Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra gathered outside the Congress President's house at 10, Rajaji Marg in the afternoon and marched to the PM's residence at 7, Lok Kalyan Marg, about a kilometre away.

Union Minister of State in the Prime Minister's Office Jitendra Singh later visited the protest site and spoke to Rahul Gandhi, but the protest was broken up hours later and Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi and others were forcibly picked up, bundled into police buses and



Security personnel detain Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi during a sit-in protest near the Prime Minister's residence over alleged irregularities in the NEET examination, in New Delhi

PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Rahul Gandhi said, "Democracy in India is happening right now" during detention
- » Congress aide claimed Rahul suffered minor injuries below eye, hands and legs
- » Rahul posted protest images, vowed justice campaign would continue despite pressure
- » Kharge called Rahul's removal undemocratic; Jairam Ramesh termed it "Amit-shahi"
- » Pawan Khara demanded resignations of Modi, Amit Shah, and Dharmendra Pradhan



Security personnel detain Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra during a sit-in protest

» Videos showed Rahul resisting police before being dragged away, allegedly bleeding from nose

PM Modi calls NEET paper leak a 'grave sin'

Says won't allow anyone to play with future of youth

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday described the NEET paper leak as a "grave sin" and said the Centre and all state governments must work together to stop such incidents, asserting that strict action has already been taken against those responsible for "playing with the future of the youth".

The remarks came a day after thousands of protesters marched towards Parliament over the NEET controversy on the opening day of the Monsoon Session, demanding the resignation of Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. The protest, called by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), was stopped by police using lathis and tear gas in central Delhi.

Modi made the comments during a meeting of the NDA Parliamentary Party, known as "Mangal Milan", which is usually held on Tuesdays. Briefing reporters after the hour-long meeting, Union Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju said the Prime Minister told NDA MPs that the government had acted swiftly after reports of the paper leak surfaced.

According to Rijiju, Modi said 13 people involved in the paper leak case had been arrested and sent to jail. He added that the government also ensured that students did not



Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah leave after the 'Mangal Milan' meeting at GMC Bhalayogi Auditorium, in the Parliament Library Building, in New Delhi

PTI

KEY POINTS

- » Says strict action taken against those involved
- » Thirteen accused arrested and sent to jail
- » Centre, states urged to jointly prevent future paper leaks
- » Says issue is national interest, not party politics
- » NEET re-exam conducted quickly after leak surfaced
- » Re-exam results declared without delay, Modi says

suffer further by conducting the NEET re-examination without delay and declaring the results promptly. Continued on P4

Wangchuk shifted to Medanta after HC order

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Activist Sonam Wangchuk was shifted from Safdarjung Hospital to Medanta Hospital in Gurugram on Tuesday evening after the Delhi High Court directed that he be moved to a hospital of his choice, holding that the transfer would uphold his fundamental rights while ensuring continuous medical care.

A division bench of Chief Justice D K Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia ordered Wangchuk's transfer while hearing an appeal filed by his wife, Gitanjali Angmo, against a single judge's decision refusing permission for the shift.

The court directed that Wangchuk remain under constant medical supervision at Medanta and receive treatment as advised by the hospital's doctors.

Continued on P4

Defiant protesters return to Jantar Mantar after police action

'No protester under detention,' says police; CJP calls off protest at PHQ

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: A day after a violent police crackdown on the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) 'Sansad Chalo' march left scores of protesters injured, the youth-led outfit returned to Jantar Mantar on Tuesday with thousands of supporters, declaring that while it would not organise another march to Parliament, its agitation against alleged examination irregularities would continue.

The party had earlier alleged that hundreds of protesters remained in police custody and announced a protest outside Delhi Police headquarters. However, it later withdrew the call after its legal team confirmed that all detainees had been released. Delhi Police also clarified that "no person is currently under detention."

More than 5,000 protesters gathered at the protest site as CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke apologised for Monday's violence



A protestor injured during the protest march towards parliament at the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) protest site at Jantar Mantar, in New Delhi

ANI

More than 5,000 protesters gathered at the protest site as CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke apologised for Monday's violence

lence and said the outfit did not want more young people to be injured.

"I apologise to all our supporters, especially the girls who were brutally beaten by male police officers. We could have done better. I could have done better to protect you," Dipke said. Alleging that the Centre was protecting Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, he asserted that the movement would continue until Continued on P4

EFFORTS ON TO RESCUE FIVE

Sikkim tunnel collapse kills 20 workers

MPOST BUREAU

GANGTOK: At least 20 workers were killed and five others remained trapped for more than 24 hours after a tunnel under construction for the NHPC Teesta Stage VI Hydropower Project collapsed in Sikkim's Namchi district following an explosion caused by suspected methane gas, officials said on Tuesday. Rescue teams continued search operations amid difficult conditions as authorities announced compensation, ordered an inquiry and stepped up efforts to identify the victims.

The accident took place shortly after 1 pm on Monday at Samardung, where 25 workers, including a few project officers, were inside the tunnel when the explosion occurred.

Namchi Superintendent of Police Sonam D Bhutia said, "Out of those 25 trapped



Rescue operation underway after a collapse inside the under-construction NHPC Teesta Stage VI Hydroelectric Project tunnel, in Namchi, on Tuesday

PTI

TAKEAWAYS

- » Collapse followed suspected methane gas explosion on Monday
- » Accident occurred at Teesta Stage VI Hydropower Project
- » Tunnel collapsed shortly after 1 pm at Samardung
- » Rescue teams recovered 12 bodies during operations
- » Seven victims identified; identification of others continues

toxic gases, creating hazardous conditions for those inside and complicating rescue efforts.

Chief Minister Prem Singh Tamang visited the accident site on Tuesday and announced an ex-gratia of Rs 4 lakh for the next of kin of each worker who Continued on P4

Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs
Government of India

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FIRE CONFINED TO A THIRD-FLOOR ROOM

Woman, two daughters killed in house fire at Lodhi Colony

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A woman and her two daughters were killed after a fire broke out in a residential building in south Delhi's Lodhi Road area on Tuesday, officials said.

The Delhi Fire Services (DFS) and police said they received a call at around 10.20 am about a fire at a house opposite Chawla Sweets in BK Dutt Colony under the Lodhi Road police station area and rushed to the site, where the blaze was brought under control at 11.10 am.

"Tragically, three people were found dead inside the apartment on the third floor of the building. The deceased have been identified as Akansha (40), Aradhya (also known as Mitzy) (12) and Mihika (also known as Ritzy) (8)," a senior police officer said.

Preliminary inquiry indicated that Akansha Sharma had been undergoing treatment for a mental health condition since 2020.

At the time of the inci-



Police personnel and forensic experts at the site of a fire that claimed the lives of a woman and her two daughters at a residential building

KEY POINTS

- » Preliminary inquiry found Akansha Sharma had been undergoing mental health treatment
- » Police: Husband Mohit Sharma, an advocate, and other family members were on the second floor during incident
- » Crime team and FSL inspected the scene. No signs of foul play have emerged in the inquiry so far

was sitting outside her house when she noticed smoke billowing from the third floor of the building.

"My son immediately rushed to the spot and tried to help the family. Nobody responded, but he kept bringing buckets of water to douse the flames. Later, I came to know that a woman and her two children had died in the fire. It is a very tragic incident," she said.

A relative, Devender Sharma, said he rushed to the house after learning about the incident.

"I have no idea how the fire started. We were told that the fire was confined to one room," he said.

Meanwhile, a government officer said the blaze was confined to a single room on the third floor.

"The fire was in one room on the third floor. Forensic teams are investigating the matter, and the exact cause of the fire will be known only after a detailed forensic examination," the officer said.

West Delhi: Blaze in Fateh Nagar building, 9 rescued

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A total of nine people were rescued after a fire broke out in the parking area of a residential building in west Delhi's Fateh Nagar early on Tuesday, officials said.

According to police, a short circuit is likely the cause of the incident, but efforts are underway to ascertain the exact reason.

"During the rescue operation, a woman, Sakshi (40), panicked and attempted to jump from the first floor. The police staff promptly arranged mattresses, due to which she landed safely without sustaining any injury," a senior police officer said.

An elderly couple trapped on the third floor was also rescued. The elderly woman had undergone hip replacement surgery just four days earlier and was unable to move. Despite their initial reluctance to leave the house, the police staff persuaded them to evacuate, he said.

"The woman was shifted onto a wheelchair and safely brought downstairs, along with her husband. During the incident, two LPG cylinders kept on the top floor exploded due to the fire. However, no resi-



An elderly couple trapped on third floor was also rescued. The elderly woman had undergone hip replacement surgery just 4 days ago

dent sustained any injury," the officer said. According to the Delhi Fire Services (DFS), the blaze was reported at around 3.50 am from a house in Fateh Nagar, near Ranbir Bakery on Jail Road.

The fire spread to two parked cars, two scooters and parts of the four-storey residential building, a DFS officer said.

Two LPG cylinders exploded during the firefight-

ing operation, but no injuries were reported. All nine occupants of the building were rescued safely, the fire personnel said.

Initially, two water tenders and one water bowser were rushed to the spot. As the intensity of the blaze increased, more vehicles were rushed to the spot.

The fire was brought under control at 6.35 am, he added.

The police said that they received a PCR call at Hari Nagar Police Station. On receipt of the information, a team immediately reached the spot. It was found that the fire had reportedly started in the parking area, likely due to a short circuit, and had spread to all four floors of the residential building.

The Fire Service also reached the spot. However, due to the narrow lanes, the fire tenders could not reach the building. The staff, with the assistance of the Fire Service, immediately launched a rescue operation using ladders to evacuate the trapped residents.

Sub Inspector Rajender sustained an injury to his right leg while evacuating the residents. Further enquiry into the cause of the fire is being carried out, the officials said.

Water supply to be affected in parts of South Delhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Water supply is likely to be affected in parts of South Delhi as Delhi Jal Board has taken up maintenance work at Sonia Vihar water treatment plant, officials said on Tuesday.

"Due to essential maintenance work on the South Delhi Main, the water supply from the Sonia Vihar Water Treatment Plant will be affected from 10 am on July 22, 2026.

"There will be no water supply on July 22 (evening), and on July 23 (morning), water supply will be available at low pressure," DJB said in its alert.

Residents of the affected areas are requested to store sufficient water in advance as per their needs.

On request through the designated helpline numbers, DJB tankers will be provided in case of need, it further said.

Areas like Lajpat Nagar, Greater Kailash South, Chhatrapur, Nizamuddin, Okhla, Malviya Nagar, Sarita Vihar and adjoining areas will be affected.

City reports 205 dengue cases, 58 malaria infections so far this year

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi has reported 205 dengue cases, 58 malaria cases and 13 chikungunya cases so far this year, with no deaths from any of the three vector-borne diseases, according to the latest Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) data.

The MCD's vector-borne diseases report, covering the period up to July 18, recorded six new dengue cases and three malaria cases during the week, while no fresh chikungunya infection was reported.

According to the report, the cumulative dengue count has reached 205, lower than the 261 cases reported during



the corresponding period last year and 269 cases in 2024. No dengue-related death has been reported this year.

Malaria cases stood at 58 till July 18, compared with 112 cases during the same period in 2025. The city has also not recorded any malaria-related death so far this year.

Chikungunya infections

remained low, with 13 cases reported till July 18 against 17 cases during the corresponding period last year. No fresh case was added during the latest reporting week.

The report also detailed the civic body's anti-mosquito measures.

Between January 1 and July 18, the MCD sprayed 2,32,773 houses, made more than 2.07 crore home visits for mosquito breeding, found mosquito breeding in 58,310 houses, issued 51,774 legal notices, launched 5,878 prosecutions and carried out 1,866 garnishee (G-8) actions. The amount recovered through these actions stood at Rs 4,16,270.

Youth injured as basketball pole collapses in Gurugram's Sector 84; investigation on

'An iron pole collapsed and fell on Kartik, leaving him bloodied and causing him to collapse on the spot'

level player named Hardik died in Rohtak after a 750-kg basketball pole fell on him and another player also similarly lost his life in Bahadurgarh, Jhajjar. According to residents, the incident occurred around 7.15 pm on Monday while children from the society were playing on the basketball court. Suddenly, during the game, an iron pole collapsed and fell on Kartik, leaving him bloodied and causing him to collapse on the spot. Hearing the screams,

society security guards and people present nearby immediately rushed to the scene.

The injured Kartik was immediately admitted to the nearby hospital, where he is undergoing treatment in the emergency ward. According to doctors, Kartik sustained severe injuries to his back in the accident, suffering fractures at three different points along his spine. His condition remains stable, they added.

Following this incident,

residents of the society are furious with the management and the maintenance agency. They allege that the iron pole on the basketball court had been rusted for a long time and was severely dilapidated. Furthermore, the pole had not been properly anchored in the ground with concrete, causing it to lean to one side.

Residents alleged they had repeatedly warned the society management about the damaged pole but no action was taken. A police complaint seeks an FIR and action against those responsible. Police said the man is stable, and an investigation is underway to verify the allegations.

RS 5.5 CRORE SCAM

GST refund fraud: 3 Delhi tax officials among five held

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Three officials of the Delhi government's Department of Trade and Taxes and two private persons have been arrested over an alleged GST refund fraud involving wrongful refunds of around Rs 5.50 crore, the Anti-Corruption Branch (ACB) said on Tuesday.

The accused have been identified as GST Officer Ajit Singh, GST Inspector Atal Bhardwaj, Lower Division

Clerk Himanshu Malik, and private persons Ajay Kumar and Ashish Mishra, ACB said in a statement.

According to the ACB, the case was registered on a complaint from the Department of Trade and Taxes over alleged irregularities in the processing and sanction of GST refund claims.

The investigation revealed that the refunds were allegedly sanctioned in violation of statutory provisions and prescribed departmental procedures.

Investigation revealed refunds were sanctioned in violation of statutory provisions, prescribed departmental procedures

Mandatory verification and financial scrutiny were bypassed, while fabricated documents and fake

photographs were allegedly used to process the claims in an unusually short period, causing a wrongful loss of about Rs 5.50 crore to the government exchequer, the statement read.

The probe found that the then GST officer allegedly approved the refund claims without carrying out mandatory scrutiny, while the GST inspector allegedly uploaded fake photographs and submitted false verification reports without physically inspecting

the business premises, facilitating the fraud, it read.

Financial investigation further uncovered alleged layering of the fraud proceeds through multiple bank accounts and shell entities, according to the ACB.

The ACB alleged part of the proceeds of crime was used to buy two flats in Rohini through a relative of an accused official. In its first such action under the BNSS, the agency attached the properties as the investigation continues.

L-G TS Sandhu marks Teja Singh Samundri's martyrdom centenary

SHIVANGI SHUKLA

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lieutenant Governor Sardar Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Tuesday attended a Vishesh Kirtan Darbar at Gurdwara Sri Guru Singh Sabha, Janakpuri, marking the 100th martyrdom anniversary of Sardar Teja Singh Samundri. Delhi minister Ashish Sood also attended the programme, which featured Gurbani Kirtan and Ardaas.

Addressing the congregation, Sandhu paid tribute to Teja Singh Samundri's contributions to the Sikh reform movement, the freedom struggle and social reform. He recalled that Samundri died in Lahore Jail in 1926 at the age of 43 and was among the 11 Sikh leaders who refused to apologise for their release. He noted that Teja Singh Samundri Hall in the Darbar Sahib complex remains the only building named after an ordinary Sikh.

The Lieutenant Governor



Delhi min Ashish Sood also attended the programme

also highlighted Samundri's role in promoting education, including establishing schools, supporting girls' education and championing social equality. He recalled that Samundri mortgaged 50 acres of land to fund the SGPC's legal battle before the Privy Council, with the money later used to create an education fund that supported scholarships for future leaders.

Smart Property Cards for Capital's Lal Dora villages

Delhi government speeds up SVAMITVA rollout

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Thousands of residents living in Delhi's Lal Dora villages are set to receive a long-awaited legal and digital identity for their properties, as the Delhi government accelerates the implementation of the SVAMITVA Scheme. The initiative aims to replace decades of unclear and fragmented property records with authenticated digital records and QR-enabled Smart PVC Property Cards, a move the government says will bring transparency, reduce disputes and simplify property-related services.

Chairing a review meeting of the Revenue Department on Tuesday, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta assessed the progress of the Survey of Villages and Mapping with Improved Technology in Village Areas (SVAMITVA) Scheme, under which drone-based surveys, digital mapping and property

verification are being carried out in Lal Dora and Abadi villages.

Highlighting the need for the initiative, Gupta said, "For years, the absence of systematic and authenticated property records in Lal Dora areas had caused numerous difficulties for residents." She added that the government was now using technology to ensure every property has a clear and secure identity. "Technology-driven governance will ensure transparent services for every citizen," she said.

According to the government, 48 villages have been brought under the scheme through an agreement with the Survey of India. Surveys have been completed in 30 villages, where final Property Cards are ready. Of the 12,232 properties surveyed so far, 8,423, around 69 per cent, are dispute-free and have become eligible for the issuance of Smart Prop-

erty Cards. The government said all surveyed properties in the South and North West districts are free from disputes, while efforts are underway to resolve pending issues in other districts. The scheme follows a seven-stage process beginning with demarcation of Lal Dora boundaries and drone surveys by the Survey of India. Revenue officials then verify the maps on the ground before assigning each property a unique Property Identification Number (PID). The records will eventually be integrated with the Delhi Online Registration Information System (DORIS) for real-time updates.

The Smart PVC Property Cards will carry ownership details, a unique property ID and a QR code linking to digital property records. Gupta said the initiative would create a transparent digital property management system and simplify property-related services.

MCD tightens drain cleaning to prevent waterlogging

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: MCD Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar on Tuesday inspected the Bhajanpura drain in Shahdara North Zone and directed officials to intensify drain cleaning, desilting and monitoring to prevent waterlogging during the monsoon.

He also ordered public awareness campaigns with RWAs and warned of fines for dumping garbage into drains. Officials were asked to install dustbins and examine mesh barriers near culverts to prevent blockages.

During visits to Gautampuri and the New Usmanpur Animal Birth Control Centre, Khirwar ordered removal of unserviceable vehicles, sought improvements in the centre's functioning and called for an action plan to utilise vacant MCD flats.

Delhi government sets up dist panels to tackle waterlogging

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a bid to strengthen monsoon preparedness and improve coordination among civic agencies, the Delhi government has constituted District-Level Coordination Committees (DLCCs) in all 13 districts of the Capital to monitor and prevent waterlogging during and after the rainy season.

The committees have been formed on the directions of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and will oversee the implementation of monsoon preparedness measures, Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) and inter-departmental coordination to ensure a swift response to waterlogging incidents.

According to an order issued by the Additional Chief Secretary of the Irrigation and Flood Control Department, each committee will be headed by the respective District Magistrate and will include representatives from the Municipal Corporation, Public Works Department (PWD), Irrigation and Flood Control Department, Delhi Jal Board (DJB), Delhi Development Authority (DDA), New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC), Delhi Cantonment Board, Delhi Traffic Police and power distribution companies BSES and TPDDL. The Additional District Magistrate will serve as the Member Secretary.

The committees will monitor desilting of drains, cleaning of bellmouths, deployment of temporary



The move comes as city continues to witness heavy rain

pumps, coordination at drain junctions and inspections of vulnerable waterlogging locations. They will also identify new waterlogging-prone spots and ensure timely resolution of issues through coordinated action among departments.

Explaining the objective of the initiative, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said, "The objective of these committees is to prevent waterlogging and minimise its impact through better coordination among various departments and agencies, so that public safety is ensured during the monsoon and civic services across Delhi continue without disruption."

The move comes as the city continues to witness heavy monsoon showers, with the government aiming to improve on-ground preparedness and reduce disruptions caused by flooding, traffic congestion and drainage failures through closer coordination between all concerned agencies at the district level.

Drawing dissent at Jantar Mantar

Protesters use paintings, poetry and satire to amplify their demands

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Wielding paint-brushes as they turned every-day images and objects into biting satire, the protesting students at the Jantar Mantar have channelled their creativity into their agitation against alleged paper leaks, transforming the venue into an open-air gallery where art has become a language of dissent.

A day after the Cockroach Janata Party's "Sansad Chalo" march was thwarted by police, the sit-in demonstration continues at the Jantar Mantar.

In the backdrop of fervent speeches and sloganeering, hand-drawn illustrations, quirky costumes, poetic placards, caricatures, cartoons and even memes lie strewn around the venue, as a generation turns to creativity to amplify its demands.

One of the most striking displays was a sanitary napkin carrying the handwritten message, "...even this pad doesn't leak," in a satirical reference to the alleged examination paper leaks.

Nearby stood a recreation of the iconic "three wise monkeys" -- one covering the eyes with a bandage, another putting a lock over its mouth, while the third pours oil into its ears.



CJP supporters raise slogans as they stage a protest demanding the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, in New Delhi, on Tuesday

The captions read, "Patti chot pe lagao, aankho pe nahi (Bandage wound, not the eyes)," "Taala darwaze pe lagao, muh pe nahi (Lock doors, not the mouth)" and "Tel kaano me nahi, baalo me daalo (Put oil on your hair, not in your ears)," urging authorities not to ignore, suppress or remain deaf to students' concerns.

History and revolution too found expression through art. Hand-painted portraits of Dr BR Ambedkar were displayed alongside posters of Cuban revolutionary Che Guevara. Floral designs dotted the protest venue, while the artworks --

most of them fashioned out of mundane objects, with defiant strokes of paint and sketch pen on recycled paper -- added a distinctive youthful vibrancy.

Historical figures came alive through cosplay. Several participants came dressed as Mahatma Gandhi, with one of the portrayals featuring blood-like tears streaming from Gandhi's eyes.

Bollywood dialogues and popular culture featured prominently in placards. One adapted a well-known dialogue from Rohit Shetty's 'Golmaal 3' to read, "Jaldi resignation do, subah Panvel jana hai (Resign

quickly, got to leave for Panvel tomorrow)," while another borrowed the title "Tu Jhoothi Main Makkaar" to caption the caricatures of two political leaders.

Another poster depicted a map of India like a biscuit being dipped into a cup of tea. "I wanted to show how the country is being treated."

"It took me two days to complete this poster. I carried it during Monday's march and have brought it here again today because I want more people to see the message," Hardik, a protester, said.

Pointing to a scarf featur-

ing the Strawhat Pirate skull from the popular Japanese manga and anime series "One Piece", protester Shivangi said, "This is a warning sign. It's our way of saying that something is seriously wrong and cannot be ignored."

Humour took the centre-stage. One placard read, "Its so bad, even introverts are here," while another featured a cartoon cockroach supporting the movement.

The protest's creative expression extended beyond Jantar Mantar. Videos edited in the style of the popular mobile game Subway Surfers, show-

ing police chasing protesters during Monday's Parliament march, were shared widely on social media, while photographs capturing the essence of the demonstration at Jantar Mantar made their way across online platforms, garnering views globally.

On Monday, thousands participated in the march to Parliament called by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) on the first day of the Monsoon Session, to push for the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, but were prevented by police.

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has registered four FIRs so far and is in the process of filing two more in connection with violence, vandalism and other incidents during the "Sansad Chalo" march organised by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and farmers' groups on July 20, sources said on Tuesday.

The cases were registered at Parliament Street, Connaught Place and other police stations, and invoke multiple provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), the Arms Act and the Prevention of Damage to Public Property Act, they said.

One FIR was lodged in connection with the violence and stone-pelting near Regal Cinema at Connaught Place, while separate cases relate to unlawful assembly, unauthorised flying of a drone during the Parliament session and an alleged conspiracy behind the violence, a police source said.

Two more FIRs are being prepared in connection with assault, taking the law into one's own hands and other related offences, he said.

According to police sources, the FIR filed at the Parliament Street station was under BNS Sections 223(b) (disobedience of lawful orders); Section 221 (hindering public servants from imparting their duties); Section 132 (assault or use of criminal force against a public servant); Section 121(1) (unlawful assembly); Sections 189(3), 190, 191(2), 191(3) and 192 dealing with unlawful assembly, rioting and violence; Sections 324(5), 109(1), 125 and 3(5) relating to common intention; and Section 61(2) pertaining to criminal conspiracy.

The FIR also invokes provisions of the Prevention of Damage to Public Property Act. According to the FIR, the accused persons allegedly formed an unlawful assembly, disrupted public order, obstructed government officials from discharging their duties, indulged in violence and caused damage to public property.

Another FIR has been registered against unidentified persons in connection with

KEY POINTS

- » Investigators claimed FIR related to the alleged conspiracy behind the violence was registered after they gathered several crucial pieces of evidence indicating planning behind unrest
- » In connection with the unauthorised flying of an unmanned aerial vehicle in the New Delhi district during the Parliament session, Delhi Police had earlier said that it was verifying the authenticity of the footage and examining possible violations of applicable drone regulations

the violence, stone-pelting and vandalism of police vehicles near Regal Cinema at the Outer Circle of Connaught Place during the march, the source said.

During the violence, protesters allegedly pelted stones at police personnel and damaged several police vehicles deployed in the area, he said.

Investigators are examining CCTV footage, drone visuals, mobile phone videos and other electronic evidence to identify those involved in the violence. 'They are also analysing social media content and other digital material as part of the probe, sources said. The investigators claimed that the FIR related to the alleged conspiracy behind the violence was registered after they gathered several crucial pieces of evidence indicating planning behind the unrest, a police source said.

In connection with the unauthorised flying of an unmanned aerial vehicle in the New Delhi district during the Parliament session, Delhi Police had earlier said that it was verifying the authenticity of the footage and examining possible violations of applicable drone regulations. Security arrangements have been stepped up across the national capital following Monday's clashes, in which Delhi Police said more than 118 police personnel and around 60 protesters were injured.



Online criticism mounts over protest clash videos

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police faced criticism after several videos of protesters alleging excessive action against them surfaced on social media a day after the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) "Sansad Chalo" march.

However, some videos also appeared to show police personnel being attacked by demonstrators.

A woman protester, an UPSC aspirant, said the police action had left her disillusioned. "I am preparing for UPSC, but after seeing the police, I no longer feel like continuing. How will I survive among them when they behave like this with students?" she said.

Another protester, breaking down in tears, said, "We are not criminals. We are here demanding a better education system. Who treats human beings like this?" In another video, a protester alleged that a tear gas shell exploded near his feet. "Are we terrorists or what? Why is such action being taken against us? The police are supposed to help us," he said.

A protester with an injured



leg alleged that the government had failed to address their concerns. "Had the government shown even 20 per cent accountability, we would not have been protesting. Because of their incompetence, we are facing such brutality," he said.

One purported video also appeared to show a police official from the northeast district slapping a young woman protester.

Meanwhile, other videos showed police personnel being attacked during the clashes.

In one clip, an officer trying to stop protesters in Connaught Place fell during a scuffle, after which some protesters allegedly pulled his hair and attacked him. Another video

showed a protester pulling off a police personnel's helmet during an argument.

According to Delhi Police, more than 118 police personnel, including several senior officers, were injured and over 60 protesters sustained injuries after the CJP's protest march to Parliament, demanding Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation over alleged examination irregularities, turned violent in the New Delhi area on Monday.

In a statement, Delhi Police alleged that protesters displayed "unruly, aggressive and violent behaviour", attacked security personnel, and damaged government vehicles and public property.

NEW DELHI: Until two days ago, many of the teenagers and young adults who gathered at Jantar Mantar had never attended a march. As hundreds joined on Tuesday, they came carrying swimming goggles, N95 masks and helmets after watching videos of the previous day's tear gas clashes circulate on social media.

As hundreds gathered at the protest site on Tuesday, a day after the CJP's "Chalo Sansad" march, the protective gear stood out almost as much as the placards. Some protesters returned wearing the same goggles and masks they had used during Monday's clashes, while many others bought them overnight after watching videos of the previous day's events on social media.

Tear gas shells were lobbed and lathis rained down on protesters at Parliament Street, Patel Chowk and Rail Bhawan during Monday's march, as slogans demanding accountability mixed with screams from those affected by the tear gas and police action.

The first-time protestors said Instagram reels, X posts and WhatsApp texts became

“Even after we moved away, we could still feel it (teargas). Yesterday taught us that the goggles and mask have to fit tightly”

their guide after videos from Monday's clashes began circulating online.

The advice was simple and repeated across platforms: wear swimming goggles to protect the eyes, put on an N95 mask, carry a damp towel to cover the face, wear full-sleeved clothes to reduce skin irritation and, if possible, use a helmet in case of a lathi-charge.

Instead of discussing slogans or speeches, many young protesters exchanged tips on what had worked the previous day. Some showed friends how tightly an N95 mask should fit, while others adjusted each other's goggles or reminded them to keep their towels wet.

Hardik, a 22-year-old from Delhi, adjusted the goggles hanging around his neck before

pulling his N95 mask snugly over his face.

He said he had worn the same goggles and mask during Monday's march and did not think twice before carrying them again. "The tear gas was much stronger than I expected. Even after we moved away, we could still feel it. Yesterday taught us that the goggles and mask have to fit tightly. Even a small gap lets the gas in. These goggles really helped me, so I brought them again today. I bought them yesterday from Zepto," he said. Despite Monday's clashes, Hardik said he never considered staying away. "I came yesterday, I came back today and I'll keep coming back. If students are raising questions about education, I want to stand with them. It is our fundamental right," he said.

Many protesters returned to Jantar Mantar on Tuesday carrying swimming goggles, N95 masks, and even salt after videos of Monday's clashes. They said social media and previous experience prompted the precautions, while some questioned why exercising their right to protest required protective gear.

Mumbaikar sends meals, wins hearts

NEW DELHI: A video showing a food delivery partner distributing meals at the Jantar Mantar protest site early on Tuesday has gone viral on social media, as the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) agitation over alleged examination paper leaks continued.

The video shows the delivery partner arriving in heavy rain with food ordered and prepaid by a Mumbai resident identified as Anuj Rawat. According to the order instructions displayed on his phone, the meals were to be distributed among anyone hungry at the protest site.

"He asked us to give the food to anyone who is hungry at Jantar Mantar. The payment has already been made online," the delivery partner says in the video.

The clip drew widespread praise online, with many users calling it a gesture of solidarity and saying it reflected compassion for the protesters.

The video surfaced a day after police stopped the CJP's "Sansad Chalo" march. The protest continued at Jantar Mantar on Tuesday, with students reiterating their demand for Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation.

Kejriwal demands public disclosure of protest FIRs

NEW DELHI: Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) national convenor Arvind Kejriwal on Tuesday accused the Centre of using excessive force against protesters during the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) "Sansad Chalo" march, launched a helpline for injured and detained students, and demanded that Delhi Police make public the details of all FIRs and those taken into custody.

Addressing a press conference, Kejriwal alleged that the police action against protesters was "worse than the brutality of the Britishers" and compared it to General Dyer's actions during the Jallianwala Bagh massacre. "The videos showed police repeatedly beating girls and students and lathi-charging them without any provocation," he said. "You are calling our students 'anti-national' but are unable to stop paper leaks."

AAP announced a helpline number -- 8588833548 -- to provide medical assistance to injured protesters and legal aid to the families of those detained. Appealing to parents not to panic, Kejriwal said the party would extend all possible support. "I could not participate in the protest, but both my children marched with the protesters," he added.

Later in the day, Kejriwal



Arvind Kejriwal, accompanied by party leaders and members of his legal team, at the Mandir Marg PS, where he sought the release of students detained during the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) protest

visited the Parliament Street police station and submitted a letter to Deputy Commissioner of Police (New Delhi) Sachin Sharma seeking the immediate release of the complete list of FIRs registered in connection with Monday's protest and the names of all detained protesters. In his letter, Kejriwal said he had been informed that several FIRs had been registered against protesters demanding accountability over alleged failures in the education system, while a number of people had been detained without any FIR being registered. He urged the police to make both lists public immediately so that legal assistance could be provided to those affected.

In a post on X, Kejriwal

said police should disclose the complete list of FIRs related to the protest, the names of those allegedly detained without FIRs and the locations where they were being held. He also visited Mandir Marg police station, where he met detained protesters and assured them of legal support. Citing information received during his visit, Kejriwal claimed that 17 youths had been detained there, with six later shifted to Parliament Street police station. He also claimed that 60 people had been released from Ashok Vihar. Kejriwal said the party had received two complaints on its helpline since its launch, including one regarding a missing student whose parents were searching for him.

SANCTUARY Bangla Sahib opens doors to protesters

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: As police dispersed protesters across central Delhi during the Cockroach Janata Party's (CJP) "Chalo Sansad" march, Gurdwara Bangla Sahib opened its doors to hundreds of youths seeking shelter after the baton charge and tear gas.

A large crowd gathered outside the gurdwara on Monday evening before many were allowed inside. Videos on social media showed sewars managing the crowd at the entrance. Some protesters spent the night in the gurdwara's common area after hours on the streets.

"Everyone is welcome here. The common area and langar are open to everybody," said Paramjit Singh Chandhok, Chief Advisor to the Delhi Sikh Gurdwara Management Committee.

He said the gurdwara did not turn away anyone seeking food or shelter and made no distinction based on identity or beliefs. However, no formal request for accommodation had been submitted by any individual or group, he added.

Families say unable to contact students detained after march

Lawyers, kin seek clarity on protesters' legal status

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Families of students detained during the Cockroach Janta Party protest in Delhi said they had been unable to contact them for hours and did not know whether any charges had been filed, as concerns mounted over the whereabouts of those detained.

Kartikyen, a resident of Tilak Nagar, said his 20-year-old brother Harshit, who had appeared for the NEET examination twice this year, was picked up during the protest and was believed to be at a police station in northwest Delhi.

"We last spoke to him around 1.30 pm on Monday and had not been able to contact him since," Kartikyen stated.

"We are on our way to a police station in Shalimar Bagh area and upon reaching we will get to know," he added.

In another case, the family of a 26-year-old Amit Upadhyay who is a law graduate from Delhi University, and is currently pursuing an LLM, said he had also been detained and was being held

'My brother had to appear for NEET twice in 1 year. How is it possible that demanding reforms in the edu sector results in police detention?'

at another police station in northwest Delhi.

They said they were trying to meet him but had not been informed when he would be released or whether any charges had been invoked.

"My elder brother is detained in the Jahangirpuri area, we are trying to get more information so that he can be released as soon as possible," Saurav, Amit's younger brother said. Along with detention, family members said that with paper leaks, delayed results and mismanagement in the country's education system, families now have to worry about impending legal issues.

"My brother had to appear for NEET twice in one year. How is it possible that demanding reforms in the education sector results in police detention?" Kartikyen said.

The detentions came after thousands of protesters marching towards Parliament over education reforms clashed with police in central Delhi. Security personnel used batons and tear gas after demonstrators allegedly attempted to breach barricades near Parliament Street.

According to police officials on Tuesday, Delhi Police has registered four FIRs so far and is in the process of filing two more in connection with violence, vandalism and other incidents during the 'Sansad Chalo' march organised by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and farmers' groups on July 20.

More than 118 police personnel, including several senior officers, were injured and around 70 protesters were detained after a protest by the CJP in the New Delhi area turned violent.

Student organisations claimed hundreds of protesters, mostly students, were injured. Lawyers alleged 38 detainees were shifted from Burari police station to Chhatrasal Stadium and denied legal access, leaving their status unclear. Police said protesters attempted to breach barricades while marching to Parliament.

TALKS ON REGIONAL SITUATION, ENERGY SECURITY

NSA Doval meets Saudi Arabia’s top leadership

DUBAI: National Security Advisor Ajit Doval has visited Saudi Arabia and held talks with the country’s top leadership on the progress in bilateral relations, the current regional situation and strengthening “energy security” and protection of “maritime corridors”.

The visit comes amid heightened tensions in West Asia, with concerns over disruptions to key shipping routes and energy supplies following the continuing conflict between the US and Iran.

Doval visited Riyadh on Monday and was received at the airport by Saud bin Mohammed Al Sati, Deputy Minister for Political Affairs, and Indian Ambassador Suhel Khan, the Indian Embassy said in a social media post.

During the visit, Doval met Prince Abdulaziz bin Salman Al Saud, Saudi Arabia’s Minister of Energy; Prince Faisal bin Farhan, Minister of Foreign Affairs; and Musaed bin Mohammed Al Aiban, National Security Advisor.

“The meetings reviewed the



NSA Ajit Doval during a meeting with Saudi Arabia’s Minister of State for Foreign Affairs Faisal bin Farhan Al-Saud, in Riyadh

progress in India–Saudi bilateral relations and discussed the current regional situation, as well as other issues of mutual interest,” the Indian Embassy said.

This is Doval’s third visit to the Kingdom this year.

According to the Saudi Foreign Ministry, Doval and Prince Faisal reviewed bilateral relations and discussed

ways to strengthen the strategic partnership between the two countries.

“They also discussed the latest regional developments and the efforts to enhance energy security and protect maritime corridors,” the ministry posted on X.

The meeting was also attended by Saudi Deputy Minister for Political Affairs

HIGHLIGHTS

» The visit comes amid heightened tensions in West Asia, with concerns over disruptions to key shipping routes and energy supplies following the continuing conflict between the US and Iran

» Doval and Prince Faisal reviewed bilateral relations and discussed ways to strengthen the strategic partnership

Saud Al-Sati. Doval’s visit comes amid heightened tensions in the region after Yemen’s Iran-backed Houthis rebels announced a “maritime embargo” against Saudi Arabia, saying they would block Saudi vessels in the Bab al-Mandab Strait in retaliation for what they described as Riyadh’s blockade of ports and airports in Houthi-controlled areas of Yemen.

Saudi Arabia rejected the claim and said it would take all necessary measures to protect its vessels in accordance with international law.

The development has added to concerns over the security of key global shipping routes at a time when traffic through the Strait of Hormuz has already been disrupted by the ongoing US-Iran conflict.

Doval had earlier visited Riyadh in February and again in April. India and Saudi Arabia share close strategic, energy and economic ties. Around 2.6 million Indians live and work in Saudi Arabia, the largest expatriate community in the Kingdom. Saudi Arabia is also among India’s top crude oil suppliers.

Doval’s latest visit comes as India steps up diplomatic engagement with Gulf countries amid continuing regional instability, with New Delhi focusing on safeguarding energy supplies, securing vital sea lanes and ensuring the safety of Indian nationals and seafarers in the region. AGENCIES

Allahabad HC delivers split verdict on bulldozer justice

PRAYAGRAJ: A two-judge bench of the Allahabad High Court has delivered a split verdict on “bulldozer justice”, a term used for punitive demolition of properties linked to accused persons.

The senior judge of the bench, Justice Atul Sreedharan, directed that the house of an accused will not be demolished for a period of two years from the date of the FIR, but the other judge -- Justice Siddharth Nandan -- said such a direction cannot be given.

Considering the dissent, the court referred the matter to the chief justice for the opinion of a third judge.

In a separate verdict passed on Monday, Justice Sreedharan said, “Rushing to demolish the dwelling place of a person accused of an offence under the garb of the same being violative of municipal laws is impermissible, the same being a retributive exercise of executive discretion and so, no action may be taken to demolish his house for a period of two years from the date of registration of



Considering the dissent, the court referred the matter to the Chief Justice for the opinion of a third judge

the FIR.”

On the other hand, Justice Nandan said there is always a presumption that the government will only proceed in accordance with law and adhere to the principles of natural justice. He further said it is always open for an aggrieved person to approach the high court.

“In my humble opinion, no fixed time period can be put for as a matter of fact, it would result in keeping the operation of an enactment in abeyance for

the said period,” Justice Nandan added.

One of the issues referred to the chief justice is whether while exercising the powers under Article 226 (writ jurisdiction) of the Constitution, a direction can be issued in rem, for a period of two years or likewise, where the government may be restrained to take any action under the Uttar Pradesh Urban Planning and Development Act, 1973, though subject to some exceptions.

Another issue is whether before initiating a procedure under municipal laws, can a direction be given to authorities to give a “notice of intent” a year prior to the initiation of the said procedure for the alleged violation of a statutory norm.

In February, the high court called out the Uttar Pradesh government for continuing with the punitive demolitions of properties linked to accused persons despite the Supreme Court’s directions to refrain from taking such actions. The court had then examined the issue in detail. AGENCIES

Juvenile accused of murder can be tried as adult if conditions met: Apex Court

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday held that a juvenile, accused of murder, can be tried as an adult if statutory requirements are met as such a crime is a “heinous offence” under juvenile justice law.

A bench comprising justices JB Pardiwala and Ujjal Bhuyan made the observations while dismissing an appeal of a juvenile against a Patna High Court verdict allowing his trial as an adult for murdering a boy.

The judgement, aimed at clarifying the legal framework for trying minors as adults, ruled that murder (Section 302 of the IPC) must be classified as a “heinous offence” under the Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act of 2015.

The verdict came on an appeal by a 16-year-old juvenile

who allegedly slit a boy’s throat in Bihar.

The high court had held that there was a need for trial of the appellant as an adult, and accordingly directed the Juvenile Justice Board to transfer the trial of the case to a regular court.

The core of the legal battle was based on a technicality in sentencing definitions. Under the JJ Act, “heinous offences” are those with a minimum imprisonment of seven years or more.

The juvenile’s counsel had argued that since Section 302 of the IPC prescribes “death or imprisonment for life” but does not explicitly use the word “minimum”, murder should be categorized as a “serious offence” rather than a “heinous” one.

Justice Pardiwala, writing the judgement for the bench, said that life imprisonment is, by necessary implication, the minimum punishment for murder since courts cannot impose a sentence below life imprisonment upon conviction under Section 302.

“The offence punishable under Section 302 of the IPC, which prescribes punishment of ‘death or imprisonment for life’, carries life imprisonment as its minimum punishment. It would therefore be categorized as a ‘heinous offence,’” the judgement said.

The Juvenile Justice Board had initially decided that the child should be tried by the Board itself, but the appellate sessions court reversed that decision.

The decision to try the juvenile

as an adult was later upheld by the high court. An appeal was preferred in the apex court by the juvenile.

The top court said that the category of “serious offences” as referred to in the Juvenile Justice Act applies only where the law prescribes no minimum sentence or a minimum sentence of less than seven years.

It ruled that Section 302 falls squarely within the definition of a “heinous offence” because the punishment cannot be less than life imprisonment.

It also held that under Section 101(2) of the Juvenile Justice Act, a sessions court, hearing an appeal against a preliminary assessment, is not mandatorily required to obtain fresh assistance from psychologists or medical experts in every case. AGENCIES

Govt committed to addressing youth’s concerns: Pradhan

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan asserted on Tuesday that the government is committed to discussing issues related to the NEET and addressing every genuine concern of youngsters on the floor of Parliament.

Pradhan also slammed Congress leader Rahul Gandhi for staging a dharna outside Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s residence and accused him of exploiting students as “political tools” to “manufacture” disruption during the Monsoon session of Parliament.

Earlier in the day, Gandhi, Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge and several other senior leaders sat on a dharna outside the prime minister’s residence here and demanded Pradhan’s resignation over the police action against students protesting on the NEET paper-leak issue.

Pradhan also slammed Rahul Gandhi for staging a dharna outside PM Modi’s residence

dents protesting on the NEET paper-leak issue.

“LoP Shri @RahulGandhi and @INCIndia continue to shamelessly exploit students as political tools to manufacture disruption during the Monsoon Session of Parliament.

They chose to stage a dharna outside the Hon’ble Prime Minister’s residence, causing inconvenience to the public and disregarding established security protocols,” Pradhan said in a post on X.

“Even after Government conveyed its readiness for a comprehensive discussion,

the Congress chose political spectacle over democratic debate. Their objective was never solutions for students, it was disruption for political headlines. For Rahul Gandhi, this is not about students. This is about manufacturing confrontation after every genuine avenue for discussion has been opened,” he added.

The education minister, who is at the centre of the controversy, said the students of India deserve far better than being treated as “props in a political campaign”.

“Our government remains 100 pc committed to discussing NEET and addressing every genuine concern of our youth on the floor of the House. The students of India deserve far better than being treated as props in a political campaign. They deserve certainty over chaos, solutions over slogans and responsibility over disruption.

“We owe our students more than outrage. We owe them answers, reforms and accountability. That is exactly what our government remains committed to delivering,” Pradhan said.

Minister of State in the Prime Minister’s Office (PMO) Jitendra Singh, along with Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan, met Gandhi and urged him to end his sit-in, but the leader of opposition in the Lok Sabha refused to oblige.

Singh said he told Gandhi that the government is ready to discuss all issues relating to the NEET and the movement associated with it in Parliament, as sought by him, but the Congress leader “backtracked” and demanded that Pradhan must also resign.

The opposition leaders were later forcibly removed from the site and detained by police.

From Page 1

Paper leak protest

After the meeting between Union Minister Jitendra Singh and Gandhi, Congress leaders said the talks were inconclusive.

“They wanted us to withdraw the protest and we did not agree because our demands were not met. We want Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan to resign and a discussion in Parliament on the paper leaks. More MPs, more Congress workers and more common people will join our protest,” said Congress MP Syed Naseer Hussain.

Singh later alleged Gandhi had assured him the Congress would call off the protest if the government agreed to discuss all issues related to NEET and paper leaks in Parliament and then went back on his word.

“When this information was conveyed to Shri Rahul Gandhi, he said that he would not agree to this alone but also sought assurance for the resignation of the Union Education Minister. He said that now I have two demands: discussion in Parliament and the resignation of the Union Education Minister. When he was reminded that earlier he had only demanded discussion, he said that now my demands have changed,” Singh wrote in Hindi on X.

“Within a few moments, after taking permission from the government’s top leadership, Rahul Gandhi was assured that his demand has been accepted, and the government is ready to discuss in Parliament all issues related to NEET and the associated movement,” Singh wrote.

The minister said the Centre was prepared to discuss every issue relating to the examination and the movement connected with it inside Parliament. Police began breaking up the protest around 6.40 pm, soon after the minister’s statement.

Later, former Congress President Sonia Gandhi, who is also

Rajya Sabha MP reached Central Delhi’s Mandir Marg police station after her daughter and Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi was taken there following her detention. Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi was detained and taken to Chhatrasal Stadium.

Meanwhile, government sources criticised the Congress after senior party leaders, including Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, led a protest outside the PM’s official residence, calling the demonstration a serious security concern and accusing the opposition of setting a “wrong and dangerous precedent”.

The sources said protests targeting the residences of political leaders were “not seen in mature democracies” and warned that such actions could pose security risks and undermine democratic norms.

Government sources said the Congress protest outside the Prime Minister’s residence crossed a line and raised serious security concerns. “Congress has set a very wrong and dangerous precedent by protesting outside the PM’s residence. It is not only a security threat, but such spiteful behaviour is not seen in mature democracies,” government sources said.

The sources also warned against demonstrations directed at the residences of political leaders.

“We should also not forget what happened in our neighbourhood when such protests targeted the residences of leaders,” the sources added.

PM Modi calls NEET paper

“The prime minister said strong action has been taken to ensure that no one plays with the future of youth,” Rijiju said. He added that Modi called on all state governments and the Centre to work together, regardless of political differences, saying the issue was “not a matter of party politics but a matter of national interest.”

Sources present at the meeting said Modi referred to the paper leak as “ghor paap” or a grave sin and stressed that those responsible must face the strictest possible

punishment. He also said a fool-proof system should be developed jointly to prevent such incidents in the future.

According to the sources, the Prime Minister said the government had engaged leading lawyers to pursue strict legal action against those accused in the paper leak case. He also noted that although the re-examination caused inconvenience to students, the government acted quickly to minimise disruption and ensure that justice was done.

Modi also suggested that the trust of young people must be regained. Sources said he proposed a nationwide outreach programme led by MPs to engage directly with students. He told the lawmakers that while it was easy to mislead young people, guiding them in the right direction required greater effort. He also made it clear that students should not face injustice because of the actions of a few.

BJP MP Shashank Mani Tripathi said the Prime Minister advised MPs to stay connected with people “with warmth and affection”. Sources also said Modi told MPs that winning the confidence of the youth should be one of their priorities.

The meeting also covered other issues before Parliament. Rijiju said newly elected Rajya Sabha members, including BJP president Nitin Nabin, were congratulated at the beginning of the meeting.

He said the Prime Minister reviewed the country’s achievements over the past few months and briefed NDA MPs on free trade agreements signed with several countries. Modi assured the lawmakers that the interests of farmers would remain protected in every agreement and that no trade deal would harm them.

“The welfare of farmers remains paramount in any FTA signed with any country,” Rijiju quoted the Prime Minister as saying, adding that the government was ensuring such agreements served both farmers and the country’s broader interests.

Rijiju said the NDA was committed to playing a constructive role during the Monsoon Session and would work towards the passage of important legislation. He also appealed to opposition

parties to cooperate in matters concerning the country’s future and the interests of young people despite political differences.

BJP national general secretary and Rajya Sabha MP Tarun Chugh said Modi urged MPs to keep the nation above everything else and dedicate themselves to its progress and prosperity.

Ahead of the meeting, the BJP posted on X that “every atom” of the Prime Minister’s body and “every moment” of his time were devoted to securing the future of the country’s children. The party also shared an old video of Modi saying he was dedicating his life to building a developed India where today’s children could grow up with better opportunities.

Defiant protesters

the party’s demands were met.

Dipke also accused the Centre of adopting a dual approach by inviting CJP leaders for talks while police action unfolded on the streets. “The government wasted our time. They invited our delegation... The whole plan was to scatter the team. You call for talks on one hand, and unleash batons on students on the other hand,” he alleged.

The remarks came a day after senior CJP leaders Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das met Union Health Minister J.P. Nadda and reiterated the party’s demands, including the resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan, the release of activist Sonam Wangchuk and Rs.1 crore compensation for families of NEET aspirants who allegedly died by suicide following the paper leak. According to the party, Nadda assured the delegation that the demands would be discussed with the government leadership but made no commitments.

The protest remains centred around the condition of those injured in Monday’s clashes. A young woman who sustained injuries during the police action continued to be on ventilator support in the ICU at Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital, becoming a rallying point for protesters. CJP leaders said all other injured protesters and police personnel had

been discharged. Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal and Union minister J P Nadda visited the hospital during the day. Kejriwal said, “Except for one girl, everyone else has been discharged. One girl is in the ICU and is in critical condition.”

Meanwhile, the Delhi High Court declined an oral request for urgent listing of a petition alleging excessive force by Delhi Police during the protest. When the matter was mentioned before the bench, Chief Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya remarked, “Don’t drag the court into all this,” while declining the request for immediate listing.

The CJP also took disciplinary action against its spokesperson Vijeta Dahiya after a video surfaced showing him eating a burger during the police crackdown. Calling his conduct “deeply insensitive” and inconsistent with the movement’s values, the party removed him from the post of spokesperson and relieved him of all official responsibilities.

Wangchuk

It also allowed Angmo unrestricted, round-the-clock access to him during his stay.

Observing that Wangchuk “ought to be shifted to a hospital of his choice”, the bench said the decision would be “in fulfilment of requirements of his fundamental rights” to life, personal liberty and free movement.

The order came after the court took note of Wangchuk’s letter alleging excessive police searches, surveillance and seizure of electronic devices during his stay at Safdarjung Hospital. However, while disposing of the appeal, the bench clarified that its primary concern was Wangchuk’s safety. “The court’s concern is only with his safety and protection of fundamental rights, nothing else with what is going on,” it told senior advocate Akhil Sibal, appearing for Angmo.

Wangchuk has been on a hunger strike since June 28 in support of the Cockroach Janta Party’s agitation over alleged examination irregularities and the NEET-UG

2026 paper leak, demanding the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. He was admitted to Safdarjung Hospital on July 18 after Delhi Police removed him from the protest site at Jantar Mantar, citing concerns over his health.

Welcoming the High Court’s decision, Angmo said Wangchuk would continue his fast “in solidarity with students who were beaten yesterday”. She alleged that his stay at Safdarjung Hospital amounted to detention. “His hospitalisation was not needed... it was like a detention so that he cannot get in contact with people outside,” she said.

The Cockroach Janta Party also welcomed the order, expressing hope that Wangchuk would have unrestricted access to supporters, doctors and well-wishers at Medanta.

The Centre, which had opposed the transfer a day earlier, did not object to the move during Tuesday’s hearing. Solicitor General Tushar Mehta told the court that the government had no objection to Wangchuk being shifted but requested that he should not leave the hospital against medical advice. The appeal had been filed after Angmo cited a “trust deficit” with Safdarjung Hospital’s treatment and sought his transfer to a private medical facility.

Sikkim tunnel

died in the tragedy. Injured workers will receive Rs 50,000 each from the state government.

Tamang also announced that a special committee would be formed to investigate the cause of the methane gas blast that led to the tunnel collapse.

He said a specialised mining rescue team from neighbouring West Bengal had reached the site to assist local agencies in the ongoing operation to locate the workers still trapped.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi spoke to the chief minister to review the situation and assured him of all possible assistance from the Centre. The prime minister also announced financial assistance of Rs 2 lakh for the families of each deceased worker

and Rs 50,000 for every injured person.

The chief minister later informed the Sikkim Assembly that both Prime Minister Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah had contacted him after the incident. He said he had briefed them on the rescue efforts and that both leaders assured full support from the Government of India.

Governor Om Prakash Mathur accompanied the chief minister to the accident site, where they reviewed the rescue operation and interacted with officials overseeing the response.

They instructed authorities to ensure the best possible medical care for the injured workers and directed NHPC Chairman and Managing Director Bhupender Gupta to release compensation to the affected families at the earliest.

The governor and the chief minister also asked the Namchi district administration to set up a dedicated mechanism at Rangpo for identifying the deceased. They directed officials to provide all possible assistance to the bereaved families, especially those who had travelled from other states.

The Sikkim Assembly observed a two-minute silence to mourn the workers who lost their lives in the disaster.

Meanwhile, Chief Secretary Ravindra Telang chaired a high-level review meeting in Namchi in the presence of Director General of Police Akshay Sachdeva to assess the progress of the rescue operation.

Officials from the district administration, various rescue agencies, the West Bengal administration, NHPC Ltd and Patel Engineering Ltd, which is carrying out the tunnel’s civil construction work, attended the meeting.

Telang instructed all agencies to make every effort to establish the identities of the deceased workers. He also reviewed the rescue strategy in detail and directed officials to use the available oxygen supply carefully so that search operations could continue safely, efficiently and without interruption as teams worked to reach the five workers still trapped inside the collapsed tunnel.

PAWAR AND KEJRIWAL ALSO MEET AGITATING STUDENTS

Oppn leaders visit Jantar Mantar after crackdown, back CJP protest

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Several Opposition leaders including NCP (SP) president Sharad Pawar and AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal visited the Cockroach Janta Party's protest site at Jantar Mantar here on Tuesday, a day after the police crackdown on its 'Sansad Chalo' march, and extended support to the agitation over alleged irregularities in competitive examinations.

Pawar, accompanied by party MP Supriya Sule, met injured protesters and members of the movement and condemned the police action during Monday's attempted march to Parliament.

Among other political leaders who visited the protest site were Shiv Sena (UBT) MPs Sanjay Raut and Arvind Sawant, Rajya Sabha MP Mahua Maji, AAP leader Gopal Rai, Kerala Congress (M) leader Jose K Mani, and a



AAP national convenor Arvind Kejriwal consoles a student during his visit to Jantar Mantar, where students have been protesting over the NEET issue, in New Delhi

Highlights

» Shiv Sena (UBT) MPs Sanjay Raut and Arvind Sawant, Rajya Sabha MP Mahua Maji, AAP leader Gopal Rai, Kerala Congress (M) leader Jose K Mani, and a delegation of Parliamentarians from Left parties

» Kejriwal also visited Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital and met students injured in Monday's police action

issues in Parliament and continue supporting this movement until justice is delivered and accountability is fixed," he said.

Earlier in the day, Kejriwal visited Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital and met students injured in Monday's police action. He said one of the injured protesters, a young woman, continued to remain in the intensive care unit.

"I pray that the girl recovers soon and is able to return home. I am trying to get in touch with her parents," Kejriwal said.

The former Delhi chief minister later visited Jantar Mantar and interacted with protesters who had returned to the site despite the injuries they suffered during the police action.

Raut and Sawant also met the protesters and expressed support for the agitation. According to the CJP, Raut

said, "The fire lit at Jantar Mantar will not be extinguished. We will join the hunger strike if needed."

Separately, a delegation of Left MPs comprising CPI(M) Rajya Sabha members John Brittas, A A Rahim and V Sivadasan, CPI Rajya Sabha MP P Sandosh Kumar, CPI(M) Lok Sabha MPs Amra Ram and S Venkatesan, along with Kerala Congress (M) leader Mani, visited the protest site and demanded that Union Home Minister Amit Shah make a statement in Parliament on the police action against protesters.

The visits came a day after thousands of protesters gathered at Jantar Mantar for the CJP's march to Parliament despite heavy security deployment and prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita. Police used tear gas shells and batons to stop the protesters.

RAHUL GANDHI'S ASSETS CASE

ED free to act if illegality found during probe: Allahabad HC

OUR CORRESPONDENT



Rahul Gandhi

LUCKNOW: Expressing dissatisfaction with the CBI's response, the Allahabad High Court's Lucknow bench has directed the agency's senior officer to personally file a fresh affidavit detailing the progress made in the probe into allegations of disproportionate assets against Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi.

A bench of Justices R S Chauhan and B R Singh also observed that if, during the course of its inquiry into the allegations, the Enforcement Directorate (ED) comes across material and documents indicating any illegality, it would be free to proceed further in accordance with law.

The court was hearing a plea that sought an investigation by the CBI and the ED into allegations of disproportionate assets against Congress leader Rahul Gandhi.

The order, which was posted on the High Court's website on

Director or the Head of the concerned Zone at the CBI's Anti-Corruption Headquarters in New Delhi to personally file a fresh affidavit before the next hearing, detailing the progress made in the matter.

The bench treated the matter as part-heard and fixed August 20 as the next date of hearing.

During the hearing, both the CBI and the ED filed their counter affidavits.

After examining the CBI's affidavit, the judges observed, "We are unable to understand the progress of the investigation done by the CBI."

"Therefore, on the next date, the counter affidavit of CBI shall be filed in terms of earlier order and the deponent of that counter affidavit would be Joint Director/Head of Zone, ACHQ Zone, CBI, New Delhi.

"In the counter affidavit, the further progress, if any, may be indicated categorically so that the court could understand about the progress of the investigation."

The court directed the Joint

Statehood imperative for restoring J&K's special status: CM Omar

OUR CORRESPONDENT

SRINAGAR: Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah on Tuesday said statehood was the foundation for restoring the special status of the Union Territory.

Addressing a press conference here, Abdullah said the National Conference (NC) will keep reminding the Centre of its promise to restore Jammu and Kashmir's statehood and expressed hope that the commitment would be fulfilled.

He also asserted that his protest in Delhi was "just the beginning" and not the end of the party's campaign.

The chief minister was in the national capital on Monday to



J&K Chief Minister Omar Abdullah addresses a press conference, in Srinagar, Tuesday

stage a protest at Jantar Mantar demanding the restoration of statehood to Jammu and Kashmir. However, police stopped him and other party leaders from moving towards the protest venue due to the heavy security deployment for the Cockroach

delegation of Parliamentarians from Left parties.

According to a statement issued by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), Pawar said the voices of students demanding a fair and transparent examination system could not be

silenced through force and assured that the NCP (SP) would continue to support the movement both inside and outside Parliament.

"The Nationalist Congress Party stands firmly with the students. We will raise these

Oppn MPs meet Birla to discuss 'brutality' on students

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Closer Look

» Students were beaten for asking legitimate questions about their own

future, Gandhi said

» If Parliament cannot discuss the future of India's youth, what is it for, Gandhi asked

NEW DELHI: Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi along with some Opposition MPs met Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla on Tuesday and urged him to allow a discussion in the House on the "brutality unleashed" on students and the government's "complete lack of accountability" for the examination crisis.

Besides Gandhi, SP's Dharmendra Yadav, Shiv Sena (UBT)'s Arvind Savant, RSP's N K Premchandran, among others, met the Speaker in his office before the House proceedings began. In a post on X, Gandhi said, "Met the Hon'ble Lok Sabha Speaker today along with MPs of the Opposition. Our demand is simple: Parliament must have a detailed discussion on the brutality unleashed on

students yesterday and on the government's complete lack of accountability for the examination crisis."

Students were beaten for asking legitimate questions about their own future, Gandhi said. If Parliament cannot discuss the future of India's youth, what is it for, he asked.

"The Opposition will not let this be buried. We will ensure that the students' voice will be heard on the streets, and in Parliament," Gandhi said.

Congress whip in the Lok Sabha Manickam Tagore said Gandhi along with some other

Opposition MPs met Birla and sought a discussion on the "attack on students" on Monday during the protest against the paper leak issue.

"We are demanding that Home Minister Amit Shah comes to the House and replies on this," he said.

Earlier, INDIA bloc floor leaders met in the chamber of Leader of Opposition in the Rajya Sabha Mallikarjun Kharge before the start of the second day of Parliament's Monsoon Session and deliberated on the Opposition's strategy.

LIVE-IN REGISTRATION MANDATORY, TRIBALS EXEMPT

MP Assembly passes UCC Bill amid Congress protest

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

BHOPAL: The Madhya Pradesh Assembly on Tuesday passed the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Bill, 2026 by voice vote a noisy protest by the opposition Congress MLAs.

The Bill, which will make Madhya Pradesh the fourth state after Uttarakhand, Gujarat and Assam to enact a Uniform Civil Code, seeks to establish a common legal framework governing marriage, divorce, inheritance, adoption and live-in relationships. It exempts members of the state's Scheduled Tribes from its ambit.

Piloting the legislation, Chief Minister Mohan Yadav described the occasion as a "golden moment" in the

Assembly's history and said the law would ensure "equality for all and respect for all." He accused the Congress of opposing the Bill for "appeasement politics" and alleged that the party had consistently denied justice to women.

The legislation prohibits polygamy, mandates the registration of marriages, divorces and live-in relationships, and provides equal inheritance rights to biological and adopted children, irrespective of whether they are born to married or unmarried parents. It also renders unilateral verbal divorce, including triple talaq, illegal under the state's legal framework.

Highlighting the Bill's provisions, Yadav said the min-



CM Mohan Yadav said the law would ensure equality for all and respect for all

imum legal age for marriage would remain 18 years for women and 21 years for men, and only individuals legally

divorced would be permitted to enter another marriage. He said failure to register a live-in relationship or entering one by concealing an existing marriage would attract penal provisions, including imprisonment of up to five years in specified cases.

The Chief Minister claimed that a majority of Muslim women and a significant section of Muslim men who deposited before the committee that drafted the Bill had supported the Uniform Civil Code. He credited the Narendra Modi government with abolishing triple talaq and said the state law would ensure that all citizens are governed by the same civil laws.

During his speech, Yadav

also targeted the Congress over the exclusion of Scheduled Tribes from the legislation, accusing the Opposition of being "anti-tribal." Amid slogan-shouting in the House, he asserted that the UCC would benefit all 8.5 crore residents of the state.

At the outset, senior Congress MLA Arif Masood said that the Bill contained numerous inconsistencies. The Union government had failed to implement the UCC through Parliament despite the relevant bill remaining pending with the Law Commission for three years, he said.

Amid the uproar, Speaker Narendra Singh Tomar passed the Bill by voice vote after the Chief Minister's reply.

Ram Temple donation 'theft' probe expands to Lucknow

LUCKNOW: The investigation into the alleged theft of donations from the Ram Temple in Ayodhya has widened, with authorities now scrutinising properties allegedly purchased in Lucknow by the accused and their family members using suspected proceeds of the crime.

Ayodhya Senior Superintendent of Police Gaurav Grover has written to Lucknow District Magistrate Vishakh G, seeking details of agricultural, non-agricultural, commercial and residential properties registered in the names of the eight accused and 46 of their relatives. Officials familiar with the investigation said the move is aimed at identifying assets acquired over the past two years and determining whether they were purchased

using money allegedly siphoned from temple donations.

Following the request, the Lucknow district administration has directed the Municipal Corporation, Awas Vikas Parishad and the Revenue Department to prepare and submit a comprehensive report at the earliest. Revenue officials across all five tehsils of the state capital have begun examining property registration records to trace land and real estate transactions linked to the accused and their relatives.

Circle Officer Ashutosh Tiwari, who is leading the investigation into the donation theft case, has sought details of both movable and immovable assets acquired by the accused during the past two years. MPOST

Govt reserves 50% CAPF, Assam Rifles constable posts for ex-Agniveers

NEW DELHI: The Centre has made the ex-Agniveers eligible by allocating a separate category in recruitment to the post of Constable (General Duty) in Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs) and Rifleman in Assam Rifles with reservation and recruitment relaxations for facilitating their induction into the Central Armed Police Forces. As per the directions issued, 50 per cent of vacancies in the CAPFs and Assam Rifles will be reserved for the recruitment of the ex-Agniveers. Moreover, the upper age limit is relaxed by three years for lateral entry candidates and five years for the first batch recruits above the prescribed upper age limit for recruitment as the candidates of the first batch will be only the ex-Agniveers who have already served for a period of four years. The ex-Agniveers seeking recruitment in CAPFs and Assam Rifles have been exempted from the PST, PET, and written examination as a special recruitment concession making it easier for them to join the CAPFs and Assam Rifles. MPOST

India must address structural challenges to achieve Viksit Bharat vision by 2047: WTO report

According to trade policy review report on India, significant progress was achieved in financial inclusion

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India needs to address structural challenges such as high trade costs, regulatory complexity, infrastructure gaps and barriers to deeper global integration to achieve its goal of becoming a developed nation by 2047, according to a WTO report.

According to the trade policy review report on India by the WTO Secretariat, significant progress was achieved in financial inclusion.

But at the same time, the policy framework included relatively high tariffs, the use of import and export controls, state trading, and extensive budgetary support programmes (most notably for the supply of food grains and fertiliser), it said.

India's trade and investment policy developments included the expansion of regional trade agreements, ongoing liberalisation of FDI regimes, and efforts to improve trade facilitation through digitalisation and customs modernisation, it noted. "Looking ahead, in the short

Key Points

» India's trade and investment policy developments included the expansion of regional trade agreements

» Currently, India has 19 active FTAs and since 2021 has significantly intensified its engagement, having signed or concluded negotiations in eight major agreements

term, real GDP growth is forecast to range between 6.8 and 7.2 per cent in FY2027/2028, continuing the trend of strong growth posted during the review period - one in which India was the fastest-growing G20 economy.

"Looking further ahead, sustaining the strong economic performance needed to reach the Viksit Bharat vision of a developed India by 2047 will require addressing structural challenges, including high trade costs, regulatory complexity, infrastructure gaps, and barriers to deeper global integration," the report said.

Building on the administrative and procedural reforms, including the Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Acts, to promote ease of doing

business, reforms to improve the business environment, enhance productivity, and reduce reliance on trade-restrictive measures could support more efficient resource allocation and competitiveness, it pointed out.

Such measures, it said, could also help attract foreign investment. As India seeks to expand its role in global trade, diversify exports and meet its long-term development objectives, the balance between self-reliance and openness, as well as its engagement in the multilateral trading system and its reform, will remain key determinants of its future growth and resilience, it added.

Separately, the trade policy review report said that the

country's export strategy over the last decade includes leveraging free trade agreements (FTAs) to enhance market access, improve economic partnership and enhance integration with global value chains.

Currently, India has 19 active FTAs and since 2021 has significantly intensified its engagement, having signed or concluded negotiations in eight major agreements.

"This renewed momentum reflects a strategic shift towards securing durable market access, reducing tariff and non-tariff barriers, and linking Indian exporters with regional and global value chains," it said.

In recent years, India's trade performance has been impacted by a range of external challenges, it added.

"Events such as global supply chain disruptions arising from geopolitical tensions, the pandemic, climate-related events, and export controls by some countries have adversely affected the availability and cost of critical inputs," it said.

India is also facing an

increased use of non-tariff measures by some trading partners, including complex standards, conformity assessment procedures and regulatory requirements, it said, adding that these have resulted in constrained market access for Indian industry in foreign markets.

The Trade Policy Review (TPR) is an important transparency mechanism under the WTO (World Trade Organization).

It entails a comprehensive peer review of a member's trade policies, consisting of a multitude of border and behind-the-border measures, to enhance transparency, predictability and understanding in the WTO.

These reviews are conducted by the Trade Policy Review Body, which comprises the entire membership of the WTO.

The review is carried out on the basis of two principal documents: a policy statement submitted by the member under review (called the Government Report) and a report prepared by the WTO Secretariat, which is circulated to all member countries.

Nation Briefs

KERALA LAUNCHES SINGLE SIGN-ON PORTAL FOR REVENUE OFFICIALS

MALAPPURAM: Kerala Revenue Minister A P Anil Kumar on Tuesday launched a single sign-on (SSO) portal for revenue department officials, saying the initiative would make government services faster, more transparent and citizen-friendly. Launching the state-level rollout of the portal at a district-level review meeting here, the minister said the system, developed using the Centre's Jan Parichay platform in collaboration with the central and state governments, would enable officials to access multiple digital applications through a single login using their official email IDs. The new system would eliminate the need for separate user IDs and passwords for different applications, reducing delays caused by repeated logins and forgotten passwords, he said.

MONSOON SESSION OF JHARKHAND ASSEMBLY TO COMMENCE FROM AUG 6

RANCHI: The monsoon session of the Jharkhand Assembly will commence from August 6, and there will be five working days, an official said on Tuesday. The decision was taken at a cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Hemant Soren. "The Cabinet approved a proposal to convene the monsoon session of the sixth Jharkhand Legislative Assembly from August 6 to 12. There will be five working days during the session," Additional Chief Secretary (Health) Ajay Kumar Singh said. Cabinet also approved proposal to hire a single-engine helicopter for emergency medical services.

AT LEAST 6 DEAD IN N-E; RED ALERT IN HP

‘Monsoon fury’: Fresh floods in Arunachal, Assam rivers in spate

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: At least six people lost their lives in rain-related incidents across the northeastern states on Tuesday as floods, landslides and flash floods continued to wreak havoc, disrupting transport services, damaging homes, agricultural land and public infrastructure. Heavy rainfall also affected normal life in Himachal Pradesh and Jammu and Kashmir, prompting authorities to shut educational institutions, suspend traffic on key roads and intensify rescue operations.

In Assam, the flood toll rose to 11 after one person died in Charaideo district. More than 3.10 lakh people remained affected across 758 villages in 11 districts, including Sivasagar, Dhemaji, Dibrugarh, Jorhat, Golaghat and Tinsukia.

The Assam State Disaster Management Authority (ASDMA) said major rivers, including the Brahmaputra, Dikhow, Desang and Dhansiri, were flowing above the danger mark, with the Dikhow and Desang crossing the “extreme flood level” in Sivasagar district. The Dhansiri River was in a “severe flood situation” at Numaligarh in Golaghat district, while the Brahmaputra and Buridighing rivers also remained in spate.

Floodwaters also disrupted railway operations for the second consecutive day after tracks were submerged in Upper Assam. The Northeast Frontier Railway cancelled, diverted or short-terminated several trains and operated special services to assist stranded passengers.

In neighbouring Nagaland, the death toll from flash floods



People move to a safer place in a flood-affected area following incessant heavy rainfall, at Phulpanisiga in Sivasagar

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Six people lost their lives in rain-related incidents across the northeast on Tuesday
- » Himachal also witnessed widespread disruption due to intense rainfall

and landslides in Mon district climbed to nine after five more bodies were recovered. Four persons remain missing, with search operations continuing. Preliminary reports indicated that at least 7,460 people have been affected, while 64 houses in 93 villages across 10 districts have suffered damage. Authorities said infrastructure, agricultural land and public utilities had been extensively affected, with the scale of destruction likely to increase as assessments continue.

Fresh flooding also hit five districts of Arunachal Pradesh during the last 24 hours. According to the State Emergency Operation Centre, Siang, Papum Pare, West Kameng,

Kamle and Lower Siang districts reported fresh inundation and rain-related damage, affecting six administrative circles. Floodwaters submerged Kalkek village in Siang district, while several villages also reported damage. The ongoing monsoon has affected nearly 1.49 lakh people across the state.

In Jammu and Kashmir, heavy rains lashed several parts of the Jammu region as rescue teams continued searching for seven missing persons in the worst-hit Poonch and Rajouri districts.

Himachal Pradesh also witnessed widespread disruption due to intense rainfall. Six houses were washed away in a cloudburst. The India Meteorological Department’s red alert prompted authorities to close all schools and colleges in Kangra, Mandi and Sirmaur districts, while educational institutions also remained shut in Theog, Salooni and Nirmand subdivisions. Landslides blocked the old Hindustan-Tibet Road (National Highway-5) at two locations in Kinnaur district, disrupting vehicular traffic.

‘Van Mahotsav’: Haryana sets target to plant 1.4 crore saplings

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Tuesday said the success of plantation drives lies not just in planting saplings but in ensuring their survival through proper care and maintenance. Chairing a review meeting on preparations for the upcoming Van Mahotsav in Chandigarh, he said the campaign should become a mass movement with active public participation to strengthen environmental conservation and expand the state’s green cover.

Officials informed the meeting that Haryana has set a target of planting 1.40 crore saplings under this year’s Van Mahotsav campaign. Of these, the Forest Department will plant 1.10 crore saplings at around 3,400 locations, while other departments will plant 30 lakh saplings at nearly 900 sites.



Plantation drives will be held in four phases on July 30, August 7, August 14 and August 21.

Saini directed officials to involve social and religious organisations, NGOs and the public in the campaign. He also asked the Forest Department to prepare a comprehensive action plan for the “Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam 2.0” campaign.

The Chief Minister said Urban Local Bodies should lead plantation drives in cities and ensure saplings are protected with tree guards. He also directed that suitable shade-

giving tree species be planted along roads, while major inter-sections, public spaces and village entry points should be beautified through extensive plantation. A special plantation drive will also be organised during the proposed marathon in Yamunanagar.

Officials said all saplings planted during the campaign would be geo-tagged for regular monitoring. Saini also directed ULBs to involve Ward Committees, schools, School Management Committees and parents in maintaining saplings and spreading awareness about environmental conservation.

He said MLAs, ministers and other public representatives would also participate in the campaign to encourage public involvement and ensure long-term survival of the planted saplings.

KISAN MAHAPANCHAYAT

Farmers’ Delhi march halted at Shambhu border

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH/ GHAZI-ABAD: A proposed Kisan Mahapanchayat in Delhi against the India-US trade deal triggered high drama at the Punjab-Haryana border on Tuesday after Haryana Police prevented farmers from entering the state, leading to hours of protests before the agitation ended following assurances from the Haryana government.

Thousands of farmers from Punjab, travelling in buses to attend the Mahapanchayat at Delhi’s Kisan Ghat under the banner of the Desh Bachao Morcha, were stopped at the Shambhu border where Haryana authorities had erected multiple layers of barricades, cement blocks and chained barricades on the bridge over the Ghaggar river. A heavy police deployment, including water cannons kept on standby, was in place to prevent the farmers from proceeding towards the national capital.



Farmers at Shambhu Border in Ambala during their march towards Delhi to participate in the Kisan Mahapanchayat on Tuesday

The farmers, who had stayed overnight at the sarai of Gurdwara Sri Fatehgarh Sahib, began their journey in the morning and reached Shambhu via Madhopur near Sirhind before being halted. Prohibitory orders had already been imposed in Ambala district, while security was tightened along key stretches of the national highway. Farmer leaders also claimed that pro-

testers were stopped at the Khanauri border, Shahabad, Karnal and near Jyotisar in Kurukshetra.

The protest concluded peacefully around 6 pm after assurances by Haryana Agriculture Minister Shyam Singh Rana and Ambala Deputy Commissioner Ajay Singh Tomer. Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann also criticised the Haryana government for stop-

SKM to hold nationwide protests

NEW DELHI: The Samyukt Kisan Morcha (SKM) has announced nationwide protests on Wednesday against the proposed India-US Free Trade Agreement (FTA) and other trade pacts, and written to President Droupadi Murmu, urging her to intervene to stop the Centre from signing the agreements.

In an open letter to the president, the farmers’ body has urged her to “instruct Prime Minister Narendra Modi not to sign the India-US Free Trade Agreement, repeal all signed FTAs and ensure discussion in Parliament” on their impact on the country’s economy, self-reliance and sovereignty. “The FTAs, negotiated in secrecy and under corporate pressure, are a profound betrayal of India’s national interest.... A blueprint for economic colonisation,” the SKM has said in the letter.

ing the farmers and urged the Centre to invite farmer organisations for talks instead of preventing them from travelling to Delhi.

Meanwhile, farmers’ protests also disrupted traffic on the Delhi-Meerut Expressway (DME) and NH-9 for several hours on Tuesday after police stopped groups heading to Delhi. Security remained tight at the UP Gate on the Ghazi-

abad-Delhi border, with Uttar Pradesh and Delhi Police setting up multiple barricades and checking vehicles to prevent protesters from entering the national capital. Several farmer from western Uttar Pradesh, including Meerut, Baghpat, Bijnor and Bulandshahr, were intercepted at the border. Police detained over 60 farmers after some attempted to breach barricades.

Manipur: 46 militants surrender before CM

IMPHAL: In a major breakthrough against insurgency in Manipur, 46 active cadres of the banned Kangleipak Communist Party (People’s War Group) surrendered before Chief Minister Y. Khemchand Singh at the Mantripukhri Garrison of the Assam Rifles in Imphal East on Tuesday, marking one of the largest mass surrenders by the outfit.

The cadres laid down 28 sophisticated weapons, including AK rifles, INSAS rifles, Self Loading Rifles, pistols, carbines, rocket-propelled grenade launchers, along with a large quantity of ammunition and explosives, officials said.

The surrender ceremony was attended by the state’s Home Minister, senior gov-



ernment officials, top Army, Assam Rifles, CRPF and Manipur Police officers, MLAs and other dignitaries.

The People’s War Group faction has long been involved in anti-social and anti-national activities across the valley districts of Imphal East, Imphal West and Kakching. While small groups of five to 12 cadres had surrendered in previous years, the simultaneous surrender of 46 members is unprecedented for the faction.

Punjab CM says Centre trying to ‘suppress’ protesting youth

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann on Tuesday accused the BJP-led Centre of trying to silence protesting youth through police action over alleged examination paper leak cases, reiterating that AAP would continue to support students and farmers.

Addressing a press conference here, Mann alleged that repeated examination paper leaks had shattered the aspirations of young people and alleged that the Centre had failed to ensure transparency and accountability in recruitment and examination processes.

“They (BJP) make claims of being ‘vishwaguru’ (world leader), but they cannot conduct one exam properly. I am

Mann alleged that repeated paper leaks had shattered the aspirations of young people

surprised at this. It is not for the first time that paper leaks have happened.

“Such incidents break the heart of the youth... And when they come to Jantar Mantar (in Delhi) to protest, then they are beaten. Where will they go?” asked Mann, while replying to a question on police action against the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) protesters in Delhi seeking resignation of Education Minister Dharmen-

dra Pradhan. The Punjab CM claimed that paper leaks had occurred in 2017, 2019, 2022, 2024 and again in 2026, and alleged that those responsible had not been held accountable.

Responding to a question on the legal challenge by private school associations against the Punjab government’s Ordinance regulating private school fees, Mann said approaching the courts was their legal right but asserted that the state government would not withdraw the legislation.

The state government has promulgated an Ordinance capping annual fee hikes at five per cent and directing schools to refund fees collected beyond the prescribed limit over the past three years.

CABINET APPROVES RANI LAKSHMIBAI SCOOTER SCHEME

UP clears scooter scheme for meritorious girls

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: The Uttar Pradesh Cabinet on Tuesday approved 16 major proposals spanning women’s empowerment, higher education, public transport, infrastructure, cooperative banking and administrative reforms, with the launch of the Rani Lakshmbai Scooter Scheme emerging as the flagship decision. The proposals were cleared at a Cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath at his official residence on Kalidas Marg.

Under the new scheme, the state government will provide petrol-powered scooters to meritorious girl students graduating from universities and colleges across Uttar Pradesh. Higher Education Minister Yogendra Upadhyay said the initiative is expected to benefit

nearly 50,000 students and has been allocated a budget of Rs 400 crore.

The scheme will cover the top five per cent of final-year undergraduate girl students from all universities and colleges whose annual family income does not exceed Rs 12 lakh. Girl students from families of persons with disabilities, martyrs and destitute households will receive special priority, with graduation alone being sufficient for eligibility in these categories.

Each beneficiary will receive a petrol-powered scooter along with registration charges, insurance, an ISI-certified helmet, essential accessories and five litres of petrol. The scooters will be procured through the Government e-Marketplace (GeM) portal to ensure transparency.

To strengthen women’s

higher education infrastructure, the Cabinet approved the construction of a 112-seat women’s hostel at Basant Kanya Mahavidyalaya in Varanasi at an estimated cost of Rs 2.48 crore. It also cleared the establishment of a 500-bed working women’s hostel in Varanasi to provide safe and affordable accommodation for employed women. The government also approved the creation of research chairs in higher education institutions to promote academic research and improve educational standards.

In the transport sector, the Cabinet sanctioned the purchase of 220 electric buses for the Uttar Pradesh State Road Transport Corporation at a cost of Rs 400 crore. The move is aimed at expanding the state’s electric public transport network, reducing car-

bon emissions and improving urban mobility.

Among other decisions, the Cabinet approved amendments to the service rules for clerical employees of the Women Welfare Department and sanctioned an interest-free loan of Rs 20 crore to the Uttar Pradesh Outsource Service Corporation to strengthen its operations.

It also approved new service rules for the Governor’s Secretariat and domestic service staff, cleared land for constructing a new Sub-Registrar’s office in Kanpur Nagar, and allowed the Uttar Pradesh Cooperative Gram Vikas Bank to raise loans of up to Rs 650 crore from NABARD, backed by a state guarantee of up to Rs 1,500 crore. The Cabinet approved convening the Monsoon Session of the Assembly from August 3 to August 6.

AN OBSERVATION BY UN CLIMATE CHIEF

‘India’s clean energy growth is like Tendulkar, Vaibhav rolled into one’

NEW DELHI: India has powerful competitive advantages in the global clean energy race, particularly its tech-savvy workforce, UN climate chief Simon Stiell said on Tuesday.

Stiell equated India’s clean energy growth with the combined performance of the country’s star cricketers Sachin Tendulkar and Vaibhav Sooryavanshi.

“India’s clean energy growth is like Sachin Tendulkar and Vaibhav Sooryavanshi rolled into one: a stellar record, but the story is just getting started – and if India keeps doubling down on renewables and clean tech, the next chapters promise to be truly extraordinary,” said Stiell, the executive secretary of the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC).

“India’s EV sales are growing – led by national champions like Tata Motors, Mahindra and Mahindra, and JSW MG Motor India and solar installed capacity has surged more than 50 times since 2014. India is now a solar superpower that’s



Executive Secretary of the UNFCCC Simon Stiell addresses an event, in New Delhi, Tuesday

turbocharged your economy, pushed up living standards and, along with other renewables, saved you USD 18 billion in fossil fuel purchases last year alone, according to the International Renewable Energy Agency,” he said.

Appointed in August 2022 and reappointed in 2025, Stiell leads the UN agency responsible for global climate change negotiations and treaties.

He said that India could seize the opportunity by becoming a clean tech manufacturing hub for the world,

positioning itself as a leader in areas of comparative advantage such as green steel, and supercharging clean energy investment.

“UN-convened climate cooperation can help India bank these benefits... and together, through international cooperation, we must continue to accelerate the global shift to clean, resilient economies. India has long been a strong partner in climate multilateralism. And it’s entirely in your (India’s) interests to continue engaging,” he said.

KEY POINTS

- » UN climate chief Simon Stiell said that India could seize the opportunity by becoming a clean tech manufacturing hub for the world
- » Stiell noted that clean energy, infrastructure and services are the next industrial revolution, and can help India cement itself as a global economic giant

Stiell noted that clean energy, infrastructure and services are the next industrial revolution, and can help India cement itself as a global economic giant.

“And it makes total economic sense to move even faster to clean energy – in India and around the world,” he said.

The UN climate chief also highlighted that decarbonisation is central to India’s development strategy, and fossil-fuel-free power now makes up half of the country’s installed capacity.



MALIGAON: The Railway Protection Force (RPF) of the Northeast Frontier Railway (NFR) has continued to provide prompt medical assistance to passengers facing health emergencies during train journeys.

On July 17, RPF personnel at New Jalpaiguri Railway Station assisted an ailing woman travelling on the Thiruvananthapuram Central-Silchar Aroani Express and shifted her to the Railway Hospital before she was referred to a higher medical facility. The same day, a passenger from the Sabroom-Sealdah Kanchanjunga Express was also admitted to the Railway Hospital.

NFR said 12 passengers received medical assistance in June, while seven more have been helped so far in July.



SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

BHOPAL: High drama unfolded in the Madhya Pradesh Assembly on Tuesday after Congress legislators staged a sit-in outside Chief Minister Mohan Yadav’s office within the Assembly complex, alleging that the government had refused to allow a discussion on the alleged lathi charge on NEET aspirants protesting in New Delhi.

Led by Leader of Opposition Umang Singhar, Congress MLAs gathered outside the Chief Minister’s office, leaving the House proceedings, raising slogans against the BJP government and demanding a discussion on the police

action against the students. The Opposition accused the state government of remaining silent over what it described as an attack on the country’s youth.

Speaking to reporters, Singhar said that two of the 21 NEET aspirants who had allegedly died by suicide across the country were from Madhya Pradesh and questioned why the issue was not being discussed in the Assembly.

The sit-in, which continued late at night, was triggered after the government rejected the Congress’ demand to suspend the day’s listed business and take up the issue of the alleged police action against NEET aspirants protesting in the national capital.



EDITORIAL
POLITICS OF
OPTICS

The detention of Rahul Gandhi and several Opposition leaders outside Prime Minister Narendra Modi's residence on Tuesday will inevitably trigger a familiar political argument. The government will defend the police action as a necessary security response around one of the country's most protected locations. The Opposition will portray it as another instance of shrinking democratic space. Yet, beyond the immediate confrontation lies a more important political story: the transformation of protest politics in India. The demonstration was neither an attempt to storm the Prime Minister's residence nor a conventional show of street strength. It was a meticulously planned exercise in political communication, designed to dominate the national conversation through surprise, symbolism and visual impact. In an era where political influence increasingly depends on controlling the news cycle, the protest demonstrated that a few carefully choreographed hours can sometimes achieve more than weeks of sustained agitation.

The operation reflected a significant evolution in Opposition strategy. Unlike traditional mass protests announced days in advance, the mobilisation was marked by operational secrecy. Leaders gathered first at Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge's residence before moving together, limiting the opportunity for preventive detentions or extensive route restrictions. Parliament's ongoing session also worked to the Opposition's advantage. With Members of Parliament already present in the capital, participation by Rahul Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, Mallikarjun Kharge, Akhilesh Yadav and several chief ministers immediately raised the political stakes. Any forceful action against elected representatives would carry consequences far beyond the immediate protest. Equally important was the decision to shift the focus from the previous day's police action against student protesters to a broader debate about democratic rights and the state's response to dissent. By demanding accountability from the Prime Minister rather than a single ministry, the Congress deliberately elevated the issue into one concerning constitutional governance. The subsequent detention of senior Opposition leaders only reinforced the narrative the party sought to construct.

Modern political contests are increasingly fought not only through speeches or legislation but through images capable of shaping public perception within minutes. The Opposition appeared to recognise that physically breaching the security around 7, Lok Kalyan Marg was never realistic. The objective was instead to create compelling visuals: senior national leaders sitting in protest within sight of the Prime Minister's security perimeter, followed by their detention. Those images travelled instantly across television channels and social media platforms, extending the protest's reach far beyond the limited number of participants. The episode also underscored how today's political campaigns blend parliamentary politics, street mobilisation and digital communication into a single strategy. The protest was measured less by its duration than by its ability to redirect national attention. In that sense, the detention itself became part of the political message rather than its conclusion.

For the government, the episode presents a delicate challenge. Protecting the Prime Minister's residence is non-negotiable, and security agencies cannot permit demonstrations to compromise established protocols. At the same time, democratic governments must recognise that the optics of detaining elected representatives inevitably invite scrutiny. Heavy-handed enforcement, even when legally justified, can sometimes hand the Opposition precisely the political imagery it seeks. Equally, the Opposition must remember that symbolism cannot become a substitute for sustained engagement with public concerns. Well-crafted protests may capture headlines, but lasting political credibility still depends on consistent organisation, persuasive alternatives and legislative effectiveness. The confrontation outside the Prime Minister's residence therefore offers a broader lesson for Indian democracy. Protest remains an essential democratic instrument, while security remains an indispensable state responsibility. The challenge for both government and Opposition is to ensure that neither imperative completely overwhelms the other. As politics becomes increasingly driven by visuals and instant communication, safeguarding democratic dissent while maintaining institutional order will require greater political maturity than either side has yet consistently displayed.

ILLNESS TO
WELLNESS



ANIL RAJPUT

THE WRITER IS THE
CHAIRPERSON,
ADVISORY
COUNCIL, ILLNESS
TO WELLNESS
FOUNDATION

Brain health
is not merely
the absence of
disease; it is
the foundation
of learning,
productivity,
independence and
human dignity

WELFARE
PIVOT



ARUNA SHARMA

THE WRITER
IS A FORMER
SECRETARY TO
THE GOVERNMENT
OF INDIA, HAVING
HELD KEY ROLES
IN THE MINISTRIES
OF STEEL AND
ELECTRONICS & IT

Critics argue
that replacing
a rights-based
employment
guarantee with
a budget-driven
programme risks
weakening both
constitutional
decentralisation
and the legal
guarantee of work

The Brain Care Imperative

As World Brain Day is observed today, India's challenge is to bridge neurological care gaps through stronger primary healthcare and digital innovation

What allows a child to learn, a professional to work, a parent to care, an elder to remember and a person to live with independence and dignity? At the centre of all this is the brain. It shapes how we think, speak, move, feel, decide, remember and connect with the world around us. Yet, despite its importance, brain health often receives attention only when concerns such as repeated headaches, memory changes or the sudden warning signs of a stroke begin to affect daily life.

World Brain Day, observed every year on 22 July, gives us an important opportunity to change this approach. In 2026, the World Federation of Neurology has chosen the theme "Brain Health: Access for All." The theme is both timely and urgent. Across the world, more than 3.4 billion people live with neurological conditions, making brain disorders one of the leading causes of disability. The challenge is no longer only medical. It is also social, economic and ethical. A person's access to brain care should not depend on where they live, what they earn, which language they speak or how close they are to a specialist hospital.

For India, this message carries special meaning. Our country is young, ambitious and rapidly developing, but it is also ageing, urbanising and facing a growing burden of lifestyle-related conditions. High blood pressure, diabetes, obesity, stress, poor sleep and sedentary routines do not affect only the heart. They also affect the brain. Stroke, epilepsy, migraine, dementia, Parkinson's disease, developmental disorders, depression and anxiety can deeply affect quality of life. Many of these conditions are treatable, manageable or preventable, but only if they are recognised early and addressed without stigma.

The real question before us is not whether India has excellent neurologists and medical institutions. It does. The question is whether brain health can move beyond large urban hospitals and reach people in villages, small towns, schools, workplaces and homes. Access for all means that a stroke patient is not forced to lose precious hours because the nearest stroke-ready centre is too far away. It means that seizures are not hidden due to fear or social shame. It



This year's World Brain Day theme—"Brain Health: Access for All"—is a reminder that quality neurological care should not remain confined to metropolitan hospitals

means that memory loss in an elderly parent is not dismissed casually as "old age." It means that a child with developmental concerns is assessed early, and that mental distress is treated with seriousness rather than silence.

India is already seeing encouraging innovations that point towards this future. The Karnataka Brain Health Initiative, supported by the Government of Karnataka, NITI Aayog and NIMHANS, is an important example of how neurological care can be built into the public health system. By focusing on prevention, early diagnosis, treatment pathways, capacity building and brain health clinics, it shows that neurological care need not remain limited to tertiary hospitals. When primary care providers and community health workers are trained to recognise common neurological symptoms, the first point of care becomes stronger.

Another important innovation is the use of Mobile Stroke Units in Assam. In stroke care, every minute matters. The idea that care can reach the patient, instead of the patient first struggling to reach care, is a major shift. These mobile units, supported by teleconsultation and emergency response systems, have shown how time to treatment can be reduced dramatically in difficult and remote settings. For a country with diverse geography, this model deserves

serious attention.

Digital health is also changing the possibilities of access. Platforms such as eSanjeevani have shown that telemedicine can reduce distance between patient and doctor. The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission is creating digital health records that can support continuity of care, especially for chronic conditions that require long-term monitoring. TeleMANAS has expanded access to mental health support through tele-counseling and multilingual services. These tools cannot replace doctors, hospitals or human compassion, but they can make care more connected, timely and reachable.

Artificial intelligence and digital decision-support tools may also play a growing role in India's brain health journey. They can assist in screening, risk identification, referral support, imaging interpretation and follow-up reminders. However, technology must remain responsible, ethical and doctor-led. Brain health is too sensitive to be reduced to data alone. Privacy, consent, accuracy and human judgement must remain central.

Internationally, India can learn from several approaches. The World Health Organization's global action plan on epilepsy and other neurological disorders reminds countries that brain health must be promoted across the life course, with better access to diagnosis, treatment,

care, rehabilitation and support for families. Finland's FINGER study has shown the value of multidomain lifestyle interventions, including healthy diet, exercise, cognitive training, social engagement and vascular risk control, in supporting cognitive health. Singapore's dementia-friendly community model offers another lesson: care does not end inside a clinic. Communities, public spaces and neighbourhood systems must become more sensitive to people living with dementia and their caregivers.

The larger lesson is clear. Brain health cannot be left only to neurologists. It must become a shared responsibility across families, schools, employers, doctors, policymakers and communities. A teacher who notices learning difficulty, a family that responds early to memory changes, a workplace that takes stress and sleep seriously, a primary care doctor who checks blood pressure regularly and a community that supports rather than shames people with epilepsy or dementia are all part of the same brain health ecosystem.

World Brain Day must therefore become more than a day of awareness. It must become a call to action for families, schools, workplaces, communities and health systems to treat brain health as seriously as heart health, cancer care or diabetes prevention. We must encourage regular health checks, faster response to warning signs, open conversations on neurological and mental health conditions, stronger support for caregivers and a culture where no person feels ashamed to seek help.

At the Illness to Wellness Foundation, I believe that a healthier India will be built not only by treating illness, but by protecting the abilities that allow people to live fully: memory, movement, speech, learning, emotional balance and independence. Brain health is not a luxury for the few. It is the foundation of human dignity.

My message for World Brain Day is clear: When we protect the brain, we protect the person, the family and the future.

As India moves forward, let us make brain health part of everyday living, because a nation that protects its minds protects its people, its productivity and its future.

Views expressed are personal

Rethinking Employment Guarantees

The transition from MGNREGA to VB-G RAM G represents more than administrative reform, reopening questions about rights-based welfare and decentralised governance in India

The MGNREGA scheme emerges from a commitment to the right to work. The UN recognises the right to work as a fundamental human right, codified in Article 23 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights. Labour laws and ensuring appropriate wages are fundamental principles. With this understanding, it is important to examine the transformation that the scheme brought to the Indian economy and whether that spirit will accelerate in the new format or whether there are some red flags in the proposed changes.

The Geographical Spread

The old scheme had universal coverage across the entire country, but the new format recommends a shift to selected areas identified by the Central Government. The Act, initially launched on 2 February 2006 for the identified most backward districts (based on the Food for Work format), gradually expanded to other districts and became universal in 2008. The thought process was based on the concept of the "right to work," so wherever demand arose, funds and access to the scheme would not be denied. It proved to be a better welfare scheme, ensuring dignity as labour was exchanged for wages. Over time, through constant digitisation, better monitoring, and convergence, assets were created, and direct payments to bank accounts streamlined the first step towards financial inclusion.

However, under the new concept, the scheme is again recommended to be restricted to identified districts. The thought process might have emerged from a paucity of funds, but the levels that MGNREGA has already achieved make it a better form of welfare than merely providing doles. There is a need to rethink this approach, as it may lead to the denial of work in response to demand raised in districts that are not selected.

Sharing of Funds

The most worrisome aspect of the new scheme is the increase in the ratio of the state's contribution to 40%, which was previously only 10% of the material cost, as this will place an additional burden on state resources. The ongoing recommendations of the 15th Finance Commission and those of the 16th Finance Commission have capped devolution to the States at 41%. The States will have to generate additional resources to meet this 40% contribution. In the past, the maximum funds were utilised by economically better-performing States such as Tamil Nadu and Kerala, while per-



The challenge is to modernise implementation without diluting the foundational principles that made the programme transformative

son-days generated were high in States like Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, and Chhattisgarh due to better convergence and better asset creation. These States often filled the gap created by delayed devolution of funds from the Centre.

The Economic Survey highlighted the paradox of poor utilisation in States like Uttar Pradesh and Bihar, despite their large poor populations, due to weak convergence and implementation. Now, expecting these States to provide 40% for the new scheme itself will be an insurmountable barrier. The scheme is demand-driven; therefore, allocations to the States should be based on the demand for work and should ensure timely payments. The States' major sources of revenue are excise, VAT on fuel, and stamp duties. Any delay in payments will result in losing the spirit of the "right to work."

Condition of Availability of Funds

The scheme is demand-driven, and therefore funds are released to the States by the Central Government only when demand is raised. Hence, there is no fixed allocation. Under the new format, the States will have to ensure the earmarking of 40% of the demand raised in addition to the allocation from the Centre. Failure or delay in ensuring the same will again have an adverse impact on the scheme. In the worst-case scenario, it may result in no work being provided.

The other problem is the rider clause, which states that work will be provided

"subject to the availability of funds." The Viksit Bharat—Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB-G RAM G) Act, 2025, makes the scheme contingent upon fund availability. Hence, there is a major shift from a demand-driven model to a budget-capped system. There will be a normative allocation of funds by the Centre, but if the demand exceeds this allocation, the funds for the additional demand, i.e., 100%, will have to be provided by the States.

Decision to Take Up Work and the Shift from Untied to Tied Funds

The right to work mandates that the local body, i.e., the Panchayat, provide work from its shelf of projects and execute the same. MGNREGA ensured that, over the years, digitisation, GPS tagging of works, and direct transfer of wages into bank accounts, along with systematic convergence by the States with other infrastructure schemes, resulted in quality asset creation. This strengthened the spirit of the 73rd Constitutional Amendment by devolving powers to local bodies. The Finance Commissions, both at the Centre and in the States, earmarked untied funds for this lowest constitutional tier of administration. Combined with MGNREGA, this enabled Panchayats to identify their own needs, resulting in quality infrastructure.

Besides, it allowed work on the fields of BPL, SC, and ST beneficiaries, thereby enabling them to earn wages while work-

ing on their own land. This helped them level their fields, establish irrigation sources, secure better yields, and improve their standard of living. The restriction of work from untied to tied lists is likely to have a negative impact.

The new shift to only selected areas and specified kinds of centrally determined work has removed local need identification and replaced it with a centralised approach. For the first time, the 15th Finance Commission started earmarking funds for sectors such as water. The southern States, however, do not require such allocations to the same extent, as much of the work has already been completed, and Panchayats had raised concerns about continuing the earlier model of untied funds. The new format of VB-G RAM G attempts to bring in centralised priority-setting rather than allowing Panchayats to determine their own priorities.

Financial Inclusion

The scheme promoted financial inclusion by ensuring that wages were credited directly into the bank accounts of the poorest households. Restricting the scheme to only a few areas will result in many of these accounts remaining dormant.

Benchmarking the Lowest Rural Wages

Agricultural wages were benchmarked against the wages paid under this scheme. The decision in the transformed scheme to suspend execution during the agricultural work season, as determined by the Centre, weakens labourers' ability to bargain for better wages, as the earlier scheme helped improve agricultural wage levels.

There is a need to revisit the structure of the scheme, as it directly affects the right of the poor to demand work. The issue is not merely one of changing the name but of altering the very structure of the scheme at the cost of decentralisation and the right to work.

MGNREGA was transformative not only in imbuing the spirit of the right to work but also in triggering digitisation and financial inclusion since 2012. It improved the quality of life of people and became a stepping stone towards enhancing the productivity of small landholdings by facilitating irrigation through the construction of wells and field canals. The scheme continuously plugged loopholes and brought about transformation by fulfilling local needs through local planning. That spirit must continue in VB-G RAM G, and the proposed provisions require careful rethinking.

Views expressed are personal

THE ESCALATION HAS PUSHED OIL PRICES HIGHER

Iran, US persist in their attacks, as Pak tries to keep diplomacy alive

ISLAMABAD: Diplomats sought Tuesday to salvage the collapsed interim deal between Iran and the United States even as both countries continued to launch attacks in a 10th day of renewed fighting.

Iranian Interior Minister Eskandar Momeni's visit to Pakistan, a key mediator in the conflict, pointed to intensified diplomatic efforts, but it was unclear what new arrangement might be reached to end the war.



Iranian Interior Minister Eskandar Momeni's visit to Pakistan pointed to intensified diplomatic efforts

Shipping through the Strait of Hormuz has largely stalled, and as the fight for control over the waterway intensifies, both sides have targeted civilian infrastructure in the region relied on by millions of people.

A barrage of US strikes hasn't compelled Tehran to loosen its grip on the strait, through which about one-fifth of the world's crude oil and natural gas was shipped before the war. The US continued its airstrikes on the Islamic Republic

early Tuesday, and Iran attacked a tanker in the strait, forcing the crew to abandon the ship.

Iran kept up its attacks against US allies in the region, and on Tuesday afternoon, sirens in Bahrain and Kuwait warned residents of incoming projectiles.

The escalation has pushed oil prices higher in recent weeks. Benchmark Brent crude traded Tuesday at nearly USD 90 a barrel and regular gasoline in the US climbed to an average of \$4 a gallon, keeping pressure on Americans' wallets ahead of midterm elections this fall.

The US State Department



Iran came under surprise attack in June 2025 and again in Feb while it was engaging in nuclear negotiations with the US

said in a new warning to Americans that "Iran and groups supportive of Iran may target other US interests overseas or at locations associated with the United States and Americans throughout the world."

Momeni met Pakistan's army chief Field Marshal Asim Munir, according to two

officials who spoke on condition of anonymity to discuss the closed-door negotiations. Momeni later met Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif.

Pakistan's political leadership and Munir, who serves as both the chief of army staff and defence forces, played a key role in brokering last month's interim agreement between the United States and Iran. Islamabad has been working to persuade both sides to return to the negotiating table to resolve outstanding issues under the June memorandum of understanding. Authorities did not immediately release details of the meeting, which came as Tehran continued its attacks on Gulf Arab allies of the US.

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio has said the US remained open to negotiating with Iran but that "it has to be real."

It remains unclear whether Tehran will offer anything that President Donald Trump would consider "real." AGENCIES

Southeast Asia's top diplomats hold security talks in Manila



Southeast Asia relies heavily on Middle East oil and gas and was severely hit by the global supply

MANILA: Southeast Asia's top diplomats opened three days of talks in the Philippine capital on Tuesday with an agenda topped by their most daunting security problems and a backdrop of unfolding crises led by the resurging war in Iran and a violent skirmish in the disputed South China Sea.

The foreign ministers of the Association of Southeast Asian Nations met behind closed doors in Manila before issuing a joint statement calling for an

immediate halt to fighting in the Middle East and the full and safe reopening of the Strait of Hormuz. "We expressed serious concern over the rapidly evolving situation in the Middle East, particularly the renewed hostilities involving the United States of America and the Islamic Republic of Iran," the ASEAN ministers said. The ministers also said they reaffirmed the obligations of states to peacefully resolve their differences and respect

national sovereignty and territorial integrity.

Southeast Asia, a bustling region of more than 680 million people, relies heavily on Middle East oil and gas and was severely hit by the global supply and price shocks sparked by the Iran war. Philippine President Ferdinand Marcos Jr. declared a national energy emergency in March to ensure the availability of fuel, food and other basic goods and prevent hoarding and profiteering. AGENCIES

Nepal govt withdraws 3% equity tax on pvt education, health sectors after backlash

KATHMANDU: Nepal government on Tuesday withdrew the three per cent equity tax imposed on private education and health sectors following widespread public criticism.

In a social media post, Prime Minister Balendra Shah said the decision was taken after the proposed levy triggered concerns over additional financial burden on the public.

After consultations with Finance Minister Swarnim Wagle, the government has decided not to implement the equity tax on private education and health sectors "for now", he said.

The three per cent levy was introduced last month in the budget for the new fiscal year and came into effect from July 17. Shah said the tax was introduced to expand the tax base

The three per cent levy was introduced last month in the budget for the new fiscal year

and make the economy more organised. However, the government took note of the public response and decided to suspend its implementation.

The move comes after the tax proposal drew widespread criticism from citizens, the media, and political parties.

"This government is people-centred, based on the trust and expectations of the people. Our main goal is to establish good governance and ensure that all citizens experience a quality life," Shah said. AGENCIES

UN says nearly 150 dead or missing off West Africa

NOUAKCHOTT (Mauritania): The United Nations refugee agency said Tuesday it is "extremely saddened" after nearly 150 people died or went missing from boats off Mauritania last week while trying to make their way to Europe.

The agency said 144 people were dead or missing after two incidents between July 14 and 18. It said 387 people were rescued.

Mauritania's coast guard has said 122 people went missing off the coast near the capital, Nouakchott. It said the boat carrying 160 people from Gambia toward the Canary Islands ran out of fuel and was stranded at sea for 25 days.

In a separate incident, the coast guard said it rescued 179 people who had boarded a boat from Senegal on Saturday. AGENCIES

Rescuers in Afg search for scores missing after floods kill at least 23

KABUL: Rescue crews in Afghanistan searched Tuesday for survivors and bodies in the rubble of houses destroyed by devastating flash floods that authorities said have killed at least 23 people and left more than 100 missing.

The Afghanistan National Disaster Management Authority said Tuesday that 80 people also were injured when floods struck the eastern province of Nuristan on Monday, causing an undetermined number of buildings to collapse. The provincial capital city of Parun was among the areas affected, authorities said.

Video footage from Parun showed scenes of utter devastation, with piles of mud, rocks and rubble where buildings used to be. Bulldozers helped clear mud and smashed concrete while local residents used

The agency said 144 people were dead or missing

shovels to dig away at piles of earth.

"The flood came through here. We saw bodies being swept away in the floodwaters with our own eyes," said Parun resident Zubair Ahmad, who said homes and shops were destroyed. "The flooding caused extensive damage and heavy losses for the local people."

Forecasters predicted more extreme weather, with heavy rain, thunderstorms, strong winds accompanied by sand and flash floods in 10 of the country's 34 provinces, the Ministry of Transport and Civil Aviation's meteorology department said Monday evening. The ministry warned residents to avoid riverbanks and other areas at risk of flooding.

Afghanistan is highly vulnerable to extreme weather events, with snow and heavy rain that trigger flash floods, often killing dozens, or even hundreds, of people at a time. In 2024, more than 300 people died in springtime flash floods.

Earlier this year, at least 110 people were killed by widespread flooding and landslides in several parts of the country.

Decades of conflict, along with poor infrastructure, a struggling economy, deforestation and the intensifying effects of climate change, have amplified the impact of such disasters, particularly in remote areas where many homes are built of mud and offer limited protection against sudden deluges or heavy snowfall. AGENCIES

Trump admin to reopen US embassy in Libya

WASHINGTON: The State Department has informed Congress that it plans to move ahead with the potential reopening of the US Embassy in Libya, proposing to allocate nearly USD 41 million to restore America's formal diplomatic presence in the North African nation after a near 14-year absence.

The department told lawmakers on Monday that the money would cover "a range of security-related activities associated with plans for the potential phased resumption of embassy operations in Libya," according to a copy of the notification obtained by The Associated Press.

The move to reopen the embassy "is essential to advancing US national security interests," it said. "The United States must remain engaged in regions where near-peer competitors and other adversarial actors are actively expanding their influence."

Libyan officials representing both the western and eastern regions of the country that have been in conflict for more than a decade have recently met with top Trump administration officials, including Secretary of State Marco Rubio and the senior adviser for Africa, Massad Boulos. The State Department had told Congress in March that it was looking to begin preparations for a reopening of the embassy in Tripoli, which was shuttered in July, 2014, as conflict enveloped the country. AGENCIES

Israel building miles-long earthen barrier inside Gaza, entrenching its division

More than 23 kilometres have been constructed in recent months

CAIRO: The Israeli military is quietly but quickly building a giant earthen barrier separating the over 50 per cent of the Gaza Strip it controls from the rest of the territory, according to satellite imagery, further entrenching the division of the tiny Palestinian enclave.

More than 23 kilometres have been constructed in recent months, running through Palestinian communities demolished by the military. That is equivalent to more than half the length of

the coastal strip, which is some 40 kilometres long and 11 kilometres wide, and home to over 2 million Palestinians.

When presented with the satellite images, Israel's military confirmed to The Associated Press it has built a physical barrier in the area of the so-called yellow line, the boundary to which Israeli troops withdrew under the October ceasefire deal with Hamas. The line was envisioned in the US-backed agreement as a temporary division

of the territory pending a fuller Israeli withdrawal.

But as the truce stagnates, it appears Israel is digging in, heightening Palestinian fears that the line is morphing into a border. Neither US Central Command, which is tasked with monitoring the ceasefire, nor the Board of Peace, the body led by US President Donald Trump meant to eventually oversee Gaza, would comment on the barrier.

Along with the barrier, the

military told AP it has developed a "security zone" around the line, equipped with intelligence and technological assets. It declined to give details on the route of the barrier when asked how far it would be extended. It said the barrier aimed to prevent infiltration and protect Israeli troops and Israeli communities near Gaza.

Since the ceasefire deal took hold, Palestinians in Gaza have feared Israel would not return the area of Gaza it controls. AGENCIES

Houthis say they'll block Saudi shipping at Red Sea gateway

CAIRO: Yemen's Iranian-backed Houthi rebels on Monday announced they are imposing a maritime embargo against Saudi Arabia in retaliation for a blockade on Yemen and a recent attack on Sanaa International Airport, threatening another vital waterway for global shipping and raising fears of renewed conflict.

A Houthi military spokesperson, Yahya Saree, said in a video statement that the maritime ban against Saudi Arabia will be effective immediately, describing it as an "equation of an eye for an eye."

There were few details on how the embargo might work, but the deputy head of the Houthi media office, Nasruddin Amer, said on X that the Bab al-Mandeb strait will be closed to the Saudis in response to what he called the kingdom's "unjust blockade on Yemenis for over 10 years."

Bab el-Mandeb, at the southern tip of the Arabian Peninsula, is the gateway to the Red Sea through which around 12% of the world's trade usually passes. A fourth of global container trade transits through the 32-kilometre (20-mile)-wide strait to and from the Suez Canal.

The Houthis earlier demonstrated their ability to disrupt shipping there when they targeted ships for months over the Israel-Hamas war in Gaza, with over 100 vessels attacked. It is unclear whether the Houthis will resume that level of attack against neighbouring Saudi Arabia.

Saudi Arabia's military said it would keep the waterway open.

"All Houthi threats against transiting vessels will be dealt with swiftly and firmly, as such threats are a blatant violation of international law and fall under acts of maritime piracy," said Maj. Gen. Turki al-Malki, a Saudi military spokesperson.

The kingdom already faced pressure as it uses its East-West Pipeline to the Red Sea as an alternative to the Strait of Hormuz, which remains in the grip that Iran imposed shortly after the US and Israel attacked it on Feb. 28.

The Saudis have been sending millions of barrels of crude oil a day through the pipeline. Now, about 2.5 million barrels of oil per day could be at risk, Texas-based Rystad Energy wrote Monday.

Saudi Arabia leads a coalition against the Houthis and imposed an air and sea blockade on Yemen in 2015. Yemen's civil war began in 2014 when the rebels seized the capital, Sanaa, and much of northern Yemen and forced the government into exile. A truce was reached in 2022. AGENCIES

New UK PM promises to lead 'cost-of-living government'



UK PM Andy Burnham

LONDON: Andy Burnham chaired his first Cabinet meeting as British Prime Minister at 10 Downing Street in London on Tuesday with a promise to lead a "cost-of-living government", starting with a tax cut to bring down household electricity bills.

"We need to be a cost-of-living government, getting that cost of living down, looking at all possible ways of doing that," Burnham told his top team.

"We are taking immediate action to cut taxes on energy bills, put more money in people's pockets and bring back hope," he said.

The government said the cost of removing value added tax (VAT) from domestic electricity bills from October 1 will bring down costs, with the policy funded by the cancellation of a scheme proposed by predecessor Keir Starmer.

"This measure is funded this year from cancelling the Digital ID programme, and it will help bring down inflation while supporting households in every postcode," said John Healey, newly appointed Chancellor at No. 11 Downing Street.

However, the claim faced instant criticism from one of Starmer's close aides shunted out of the Cabinet in Monday's reshuffle. "But the Digital ID program was unfunded. The government will have to set out how it will pay for its new policies at the Budget," Darren Jones, former chief secretary to the UK Treasury, posted. AGENCIES

S. E. RAILWAY - TENDER

Sr. DEE/TRD/CKP acting for & on behalf of The President of India invites e-Tender as mentioned below. Tenders are due to open on 07.08.2026 at 15.30 hrs. The Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. Sl. No., Tender Notice No., Name of the work, Tender Value, Earnest Money, (1): CKP-D-634-Maint-ELS-BNDM; OHE work in connection with construction of shed for creation of advanced maintenance facility at ELS/BNDM in CKP Division; ₹ 9,43,074.97; ₹ 18,900; (2): CKP-D-653-Sink Mast-DPS; Replacement of sink masts / low height masts for improvement of contract wire height in the jurisdiction of ADEE/TRD/DPS in Chakradharpur Division. (Ph-I); ₹ 2,21,99,328.71; ₹ 4,44,000; (3): CKP-D-654-TATA-SINK-MAST; Replacement of sink mast / low height masts for improvement of contract wire height in the jurisdiction of ADEE/TRD/ TATA in Chakradharpur Division (Ph-I); ₹ 1,93,88,492.65; ₹ 3,87,000; (4): CKP-D-659-DepotManning; Manning / upkeep of non-core traction assets of different OHE/PSI depots (17 nos.) including Manning of Tower Wagons / cars of CKP Division for two years; ₹ 2,57,53,903.68; ₹ 2,78,800; Completion of Period: 06 Months (For Sl. No. 1), 12 Months (For Sl. No. 2 & 3), 24 Months (For Sl. No. 4); Date & Time of opening of tender : 15.30 hrs. of 07.08.2026 (For Sl. No. 1 to 4); Date and time of closing of tender: 15.00 hrs. of 07.08.2026 (For Sl. No. 1 to 4); Place of opening of e-tender- Sr.DEE/TRD/South Eastern Railway; e-tender can be viewed at Website <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. The tenderer/bidders must have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate & must be registered on IREPS Portal. Only registered tenderer/bidders can participate on E-Tendering. All relevant paper must be uploaded at the time of participating in E-tendering. (PR-499)

M.P. MADHYA KSHETRA VIDYUT VITARAN CO. LTD.
OFFICE OF THE GENERAL MANAGER (CITY) CIRCLE, GWALIOR
ROSHNIGARH, INDERGANJ, GWALIOR-474009
TEL : 0751-2448207, 0751-2448276, E-mail : secitygwalior1@gmail.com
NO.GM/CC/GWL/PUR/NIT/25-26/3797 Gwalior Dated : 20.07.2026

TENDER NOTICE

MPMKVCL, Gwalior invites bids for following item through e-tendering

Particulars	Approx. Value (In. Lakh)	Tender Fee (inclusive of GST @18%) (In Rs.)	Opening Date of Tender online
Empanelment of Agencies for Restoration of Distribution Infrastructure during Emergency in City Circle Gwalior	100.00 Lakhs	5900/-	11.08.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.

Other details, terms and conditions are available on company website: <https://portal.mpcz.in> & <https://mptenders.gov.in> or the under signed office.
M.P. Madhyam/127082/2026 GM (CITY)

CHHATTISGARH STATE POWER TRANSMISSION COMPANY LIMITED
(A Govt. of Chhattisgarh Undertaking) GSTN-22AADCC5773E1ZX CIN:U40108CT2003SGC015820
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR (LINE) Block-4, Near CSPTCL Dispensary, Dagania, Raipur (C.G.)
Website: www.cspc.co.in E-Mail- ce.eht@cspc.co.in Phone no. 0771 - 2574221, 2574028 Fax No.2574222
No. 02-05/Line/O.S./Tender-59/915 Raipur, Date: 20.07.2026

E-NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Tender No.	Name of Work	Cost of Tender Form	E.M.D. (Rs.)	Tentative Cost (Rs.)	Date of opening
Tender-59 RFX No. 8100053017	Deployment of 49 Nos. Unskilled Manpower through outsource under SE, (EHT:C&M) Circle, Bilaspur, for EE (EHT:Maint) Dn CSPTCL Bilaspur and EE (EHT:Maint) Dn CSPTCL Korba for a period of 12 Months	Rs. 5000/- (Incl. GST)	Rs. 1,05,184/-	Rs. 1.05 Crore	14.08.2026

For all other details of NIT and terms & conditions, please visit our website www.cspc.co.in/cspcl_tendernotices/CSPTCL_Tender.htm. EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR (LINE) CSPTCL, Raipur

-500 MN PEOPLE COULD STILL FACE CHRONIC HUNGER BY 2030-

Conflicts and energy shocks threaten progress against global hunger: UN

ROME: Conflicts and disruptions to global energy markets could push millions more people into hunger by driving up fuel, fertiliser and food costs, the head of the Rome-based International Fund for Agricultural Develop-



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Niraj Kumar Mahto, S/o Late Shri Surya Nand Mahto, presently residing at D7-605, Habitat Residences, Sector 78, Faridabad, Haryana, and permanently residing at Ward No. 5, Balchanda, Araria, Bihar, hereby declare that the names "Shri Surya Nand Mahto" and "Shri Surya Narayan Mahto" appearing in different records and documents refer to one and the same person, namely my late father. Henceforth, both names shall be treated as referring to the same individual for all purposes.

said geopolitical tensions and potential disruptions to shipping and energy supplies, including uncertainty surrounding the Strait of Hormuz during the Iran war, could leave an additional 9-18 million people facing hunger if the shocks persist. "We are in a current era where we have the highest number of conflicts and are still increasing," Lario said. "Whenever there is a conflict, also hunger, displacement, refugees increase."

Conflict remains one of the biggest obstacles to reducing hunger worldwide, Lario added. Wars and geopolitical tensions can disrupt shipping, energy supplies and agricultural inputs, increasing costs across food systems already strained by inflation. AGENCIES

MACROECONOMIC FUNDAMENTALS STRONG

Govt rejects concern that weak rupee reflects weak economy

‘Various domestic & global factors influence exchange rate of INR, including movements in the Dollar Index, trends in capital flows, etc’

NEW DELHI: The government on Tuesday rejected concerns that the weakening of the Indian rupee against the US dollar reflects poor health of the economy, saying the country’s macroeconomic fundamentals remain strong and economic activity continues to show resilience.

In a written reply to an unstarred question in the Rajya Sabha, Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary said the exchange rate of the Indian rupee is influenced by a number of domestic and global factors, including movements in the Dollar Index, capital flows, interest rates, crude oil prices and the current account deficit.

He stated, “Various domestic and global factors influence the exchange rate of the Indian Rupee (INR), including movements in the Dollar Index, trends in capital flows, interest rates, crude oil prices, and the current account deficit. At present, the macroeconomic fundamentals of the Indian economy remain strong”

The minister said that despite these factors, the Indian economy continues to remain on a strong footing. He said real



Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary said that despite these factors, the Indian economy continues to remain on a strong footing

GDP has consistently grown at over 7 per cent during the last three years, supported by robust domestic demand, healthy corporate balance sheets and prudent fiscal management.

The government also said that high-frequency indicators for the first quarter of 2026-27 point to sustained momentum in economic activity and domestic demand, indicating the continued resilience of the Indian economy.

Responding to questions on measures being taken to address pressure on the rupee, the government said the value of the Indian rupee is market-determined, and there is no target or specific level or band for the currency.

It said the RBI regularly monitors the foreign exchange market and intervenes in situations of excess volatility. The RBI also keeps track of major global developments that could

Highlights

- » The minister said real GDP has consistently grown at over 7% during last three years
- » On external sector, the govt said external debt remains sustainable & prudently managed
- » As of end-March 2026, India’s external debt stood at \$762.8 bn against \$736.4 bn a year ago. Debt service ratio fell from 6.6 at end-March 2025 to 5.8 at end-March 2026

affect the USD-INR exchange rate, including monetary policy actions of major central banks, important global economic data releases, OPEC+ decisions, geopolitical developments, and movements in G-10 and emerging market economy currencies.

The government said the RBI has taken several measures to boost foreign exchange inflows and ease depreciation pressure on the rupee.

These include changes to the External Commercial Borrowings framework in February 2026, expansion of the Fully Accessible Route for government securities, higher investment limits for Non-Resident Indians (NRIs), Overseas Citizens of India (OCIs) and other eligible overseas investors, a swap facility for fresh Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) [FCNR(B)] deposits, concessional forex swap facilities for eligible borrowings, and restoration of the export realisation period to nine months.

On India’s external sector, the government said external debt remains sustainable and prudently managed. As of end-March 2026, India’s external debt stood at \$762.8 billion, compared with \$736.4 billion a year earlier. The debt service ratio declined from 6.6 at end-March 2025 to 5.8 at end-March 2026.

The government added that as of June 12, 2026, India’s forex reserves stood at \$671.6 billion, providing an import cover of 10.3 months of goods and covering 88 per cent of the country’s external debt outstanding as of end-March 2026.

FPIs pull out ₹4.58 lakh crore from equities during Oct 2024–Apr 2026

According to data provided by Ministry of Finance, the debt segment in contrast saw a net inflow of Rs 72,701 cr

NEW DELHI: Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) withdrew a net Rs 4.58 lakh crore from Indian equities between October 2024 and April 2026, with the government attributing the outflows to a combination of domestic and global factors, including geopolitical tensions, trade tariff uncertainties, currency movements and portfolio rebalancing by global funds.

According to data provided by the Ministry of Finance in the Rajya Sabha on Tuesday, The equity segment recorded a cumulative net outflow of Rs 4,58,438 crore during the period from October 1, 2024, to April 30, 2026. In contrast, the debt segment saw a net inflow of Rs 72,701 crore during the same period.

The government said the recent foreign portfolio outflows from Indian equities were part of a broader pattern seen across emerging markets and were not entirely specific to India.

The data showed that net FPI flows into Indian equities stood at Rs 2,08,212 crore in 2023-24, before turning negative in subsequent financial years. Equity flows recorded a net outflow of Rs 1,27,041 crore in 2024-25 and Rs 1,80,832 crore in 2025-26.

In the current financial year 2026-27, equity markets have recorded a net FPI inflow of Rs 25,807 crore up to July 13, 2026.



In current financial year 2026-27, equity markets have recorded a net FPI inflow of Rs 25,807 crore up to July 13, 2026

The debt segment recorded net inflows of Rs 1,18,087 crore in 2024-25, Rs 1,43,162 crore in 2025-26 and Rs 56,694 crore in 2026-27 up to July 13.

Responding to concerns over India’s reliance on foreign portfolio flows amid declining net Foreign Direct Investment (FDI), the government said FDI enhances the country’s productive capacity and employment, while FPI complements FDI by deepening financial markets and improv-

ing access to capital.

The government also highlighted the growing strength of domestic institutional investors (DIIs), including mutual funds, Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs), insurance companies and pension funds.

According to data cited by the government, assets under management of the mutual fund industry more than doubled from Rs 33.67 lakh crore as of June 2021 to Rs 82.22 lakh crore as of June 2026.

Similarly, investments made by AIFs rose from Rs 2 lakh crore as of March 2021 to Rs 6.76 lakh crore as of March 2026.

The government said regulators, including SEBI, IRDAI and PFRDA, have put in place regulations to support the orderly growth of the domestic institutional investor segment.

Banks, financial institutions report fraud of ₹1.42L cr in last 5 yrs: Govt

NEW DELHI: Banks and financial institutions reported fraud of Rs 1.42 lakh crore in the last five financial years and recovery to the tune of Rs 6,389 crore was made during the period, Parliament was informed on Tuesday.

In a written reply to Rajya Sabha, Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary said his ministry has been apprised by RBI that it is not maintaining information pertaining to the action taken against wilful defaulters.

However, as per data reported by public sector banks, as on March 31, 2026, suits for recovery were filed against 15,577 wilful defaulters and action under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest (SARFAESI) Act was initiated in

As on March 31, 2026, PSBs have recovered an aggregate amount of Rs 52,360 crore from wilful defaulters

10,894 cases.

Besides, FIRs were filed in 7,173 cases.

Public sector banks (PSBs), as on March 31, 2026, have recovered an aggregate amount of Rs 52,360 crore from wilful defaulters.

Further, he said, recovery in accounts classified as fraud is an ongoing process and as per RBI data, an aggregate recovery of Rs 6,389 crore was made in such accounts during the last

five financial years.

“As per RBI inputs, during the last five financial years, an aggregate amount involved in frauds, based on the date of reporting in Commercial Banks and All India Financial Institutions was Rs 1,42,112 crore,” Chaudhary said.

In reply to another question, Chaudhary said, in FY26, 18,021 complaints were received against banks regarding recovery agencies, which was more than double of 8,623 complaints in the previous year.

To strengthen safeguards and accountability to protect borrowers from coercive recovery practices, RBI has directed banks, vide a notification dated November 28, 2025, that they shall not resort to undue harassment, and have a due diligence process for engagement of recovery agents, he said.

MUMBAI: Benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty closed lower on Tuesday, dragged by selling in HDFC Bank for the second day alongside risk-off sentiment amid escalating West Asia crisis.

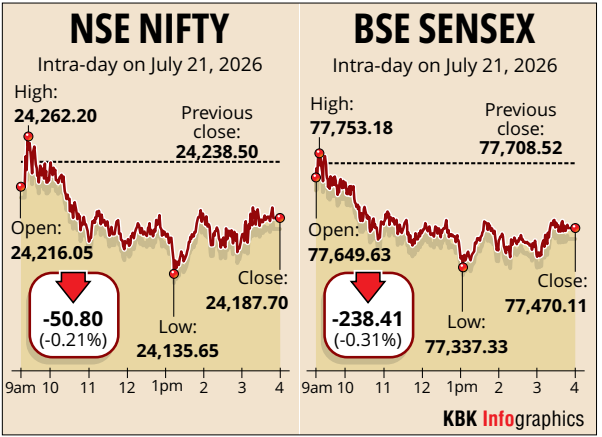
Falling for the second day, the 30-share BSE Sensex declined 238.41 points, or 0.31 per cent, to settle at 77,470.11 with nine of its constituents closing lower and 21 with gains.

The 50-share NSE Nifty dropped by 50.80 points, or 0.21 per cent, to end at 24,187.70.

From the Sensex pack, HDFC Bank declined for the second day, down 2 per cent, after the lender’s quarterly earnings disappointed on the margin front.

Among others, Reliance Industries dropped 1.48 per

Markets fall for 2nd day, dragged by HDFC Bank, West Asia crisis as Sensex falls 238 pts



cent, State Bank of India by 1.48 per cent, Tata Consultancy Services by 1.32 per cent, Infosys by 1.24 per cent and Trent by 1.1 per cent.

On the other hand, Bajaj Finserv emerged as the biggest

gainer, rising by 2.07 per cent. InterGlobe Aviation, UltraTech Cement, HCL Tech, Mahindra & Mahindra and Titan were also among the winners.

Among sectors, PSU Bank declined by 0.82 per cent, fol-

lowed by Focused IT (0.68 per cent), IT (0.66 per cent), Top 10 Banks (0.52 per cent), Energy (0.44 per cent) and Financial Services (0.22 per cent). Among gainers, MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt surged 2.94 per cent, Realty jumped 1.08 per cent, Commodities (0.98 per cent), Telecom (0.97 per cent), Auto (0.88 per cent) and Services (0.45 per cent).

Broader markets maintained their positive bias, with the BSE MidCap Select index going up by 0.20 per cent and the SmallCap Select index edging higher by 0.16 per cent.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 1,121.04 crore on Monday, according to exchange data. Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, climbed 0.66 per cent to \$90.03 per barrel.

Rupee rises 11 paise to 96.25 against dollar



MUMBAI: Rupee pared initial losses and settled for the day higher by 11 paise at 96.25 against the US dollar on Tuesday, as traders assessed the strong inflows related to the Reserve Bank’s initiatives to support foreign exchange liquidity amid global market uncertainties.

Forex traders said India attracted \$20.72 billion in forex inflows under the swap facility since June, providing significant structural support to the country’s balance of payments position.

At the interbank foreign exchange, the rupee opened at 96.41 against the US dollar and traded in the range of 96.13 to 96.42 during the day.

The domestic unit finally settled for the day at 96.25, higher by 11 paise from its previous close.

Meanwhile, the dollar index, which gauges the greenback’s strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading lower by 0.03 per cent at 100.91.

The USD/INR pair continue to remain under pressure as the dollar index has touched 100.91 while oil prices were well bid at \$89.44 per barrel, traders said, adding that the US-Iran conflict and the Houthi-Saudi blockade could again risk the Middle East oil supplies.

Urban Challenge Fund cleared projects worth ₹31K cr, says D Thara, Additional Secy, MoHUA

NEW DELHI: India’s Urban Challenge Fund has approved Rs 31,000 crore worth of projects within 20 to 25 days of its guidelines being finalised, D Thara, Additional Secretary at the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA), said at the ninth edition of the FICCI Urban Infrastructure and Innovation Summit.

Of projects approved so far, 44 per cent of financing is coming from non-banking financial companies, 22 per cent from public-private partnerships, 5 to 7 per cent from bonds, with commercial banks accounting for the remainder, Thara noted.

Sanjay Kulshrestha, Chairman and Managing Director, HUDCO, noted that cities



generate 60 to 70 per cent of India’s GDP from barely 3 per cent of its land, and characterised the Urban Challenge Fund as marking a shift from subsidy-based programmes to a challenge-based model. Viability gap funding under the scheme can cover up to 50 per cent of project cost, split evenly between the central and state

governments, with the balance to be raised by lenders and private equity.

Jagan Shah, Professor of Practice at IIT Delhi’s Transportation Research and Injury Prevention Centre, argued that the private sector, rather than government, should drive the ‘imagination’ behind urban renewal, pointing to local

capacity constraints in India’s tier-two and tier-three towns.

JVS Ramakrishna, Lead, FICCI Core Group on Urban Development & CEO, ParadigmIT Cybersecurity, framed 2026 as a turning point in which economic activity should be organised around city economic regions rather than municipal boundaries, with success measured by their ability to attract investments, generate employment, foster innovation and create sustainable economic value.

FICCI Director General Jyoti Vij said that urban development now extends well beyond physical infrastructure to governance, technology and finance.

Sebi asks depositories to implement buyback framework from August 1

NEW DELHI: Capital markets regulator Sebi on Tuesday directed depositories to put in place an operational framework and necessary system enhancements by August 1 to implement the newly introduced mechanism for freezing promoter holdings at the ISIN level during share buybacks.

In a circular, Sebi asked depositories to issue operational guidelines covering the implementation of the ISIN-level freeze on promoter and promoter group holdings, including the format for listed companies to issue freezing instructions.

The framework will also lay down operational modali-

ties for permitting promoters to tender shares in buybacks conducted through the tender offer route and for allowing the invocation or release of encumbrances created before the commencement of the buyback period.

In such cases, the freeze will continue to apply to the invoked or released shares or other specified securities.

“The depositories shall ensure that the operational framework and the necessary system enhancements are put in place before August 1, 2026,” Sebi said.

The circular follows the regulator’s notification issued on July 1, 2026, which amended the Sebi (Buy-back

of Securities) Regulations, 2018. Under the amended rules, promoter and promoter group holdings, including those of their associates, will remain frozen at the ISIN level from the date the board of directors or shareholders approve the buyback until the offer closes.

The amended regulations provide two exceptions — promoters can tender shares in buybacks undertaken through the tender offer route, and encumbrances created before the commencement of the buyback period may be invoked, while ensuring that the freeze continues to apply to the invoked or released shares.

Maruti Suzuki to hike prices by up to ₹30K from August

NEW DELHI: Car market leader Maruti Suzuki India on Tuesday said it will hike prices of its vehicles across models by up to Rs 30,000 from August to partially offset the sustained increase in input costs.

The exact quantum of change will vary from model to model, Maruti Suzuki India said in a regulatory filing.

“In view of the continuous sustained increase in input costs, the company has decided to increase the prices of its models across its portfolio by up to Rs 30,000,” it said. The increase in prices will come into effect from August 2026. “For the past few months, the company has

been making continuous efforts to mitigate the cost impact to the extent possible through cost reduction measures,” it added.

However, with inflationary pressure at elevated levels and the adverse cost environment continuing, the company said it is constrained to pass on a portion of the increased costs to the market, while continuing to ensure that the impact on customers is kept to the minimum extent possible.

The company sells a range of cars and SUVs from entry-level S-Presso to premium utility vehicle Invicto priced between Rs 3.5 lakh and Rs 28.70 lakh (ex-showroom).

NEW DELHI: Gross Non-Performing Assets (NPAs) of scheduled commercial banks (SCBs) declined to 1.73 per cent as of March 2026 from 2.75 per cent at the end of March 2024, reflecting a sustained improvement, the Rajya Sabha was told on Tuesday.

According to data provided by the Ministry of Finance, NPAs of Public Sector Banks (PSBs) declined sharply from Rs 6.16 lakh crore as of March 31, 2021, to Rs 2.45 lakh crore as of March 31, 2026.

Private Sector Banks also recorded a decline in NPAs over the period, from Rs 2.02 lakh

crore in March 2021 to Rs 1.26 lakh crore in March 2026. NPAs of foreign banks fell from Rs 10,199 crore to Rs 3,990 crore during the same period.

Small Finance Banks (SFBs), however, reported NPAs of Rs 10,448 crore as of March 2026, compared with Rs 5,971 crore in March 2021. NPAs of Urban Cooperative Banks declined from Rs 37,993 crore to Rs 21,769 crore during the period.

The government said NPAs are closed when full recovery is received or through compromise settlements between borrowers and banks, in accordance with Reserve Bank of

CLOSER LOOK

- » Private Sector Banks also recorded a decline in NPAs over the period, from Rs 2.02 lakh crore in March 2021 to Rs 1.26 lakh crore in March 2026
- » NPAs of foreign banks fell from Rs 10,199 crore to Rs 3,990 crore during the same period
- » SFBs, however, reported NPAs of Rs 10,448 crore as of March 2026 against Rs 5,971 crore in March 2021

India (RBI) guidelines and the internal policies of banks.

It also clarified that loan write-offs are an accounting procedure used by banks to clean their balance sheets of bad debts and do not amount

to reduce and recover NPAs, including implementation of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC), amendments to the SARFAESI Act and the Recovery of Debt and Bankruptcy Act, and the introduction of comprehensive Early Warning Systems in public sector banks.

PSBs have also established dedicated Stressed Asset Management Verticals for focused resolution and recovery, while the RBI’s Prudential Framework for Resolution of Stressed Assets provides incentives for lenders to adopt resolution plans at an early stage.

For Multi-State Cooperative Societies, amendments introduced in 2023 include the appointment of a Cooperative Ombudsman to address member grievances, Information Officers to improve transparency and concurrent audits for societies with turnover or deposits exceeding Rs 500 crore.

The government said these measures are aimed at strengthening recovery mechanisms, improving financial stability and protecting the confidence of investors and depositors in the banking and cooperative sectors.

India’s debt-to-GDP ratio eases to 58.2% in FY26: Govt

As of March 31, 2026, total debt of the Centre stood at Rs 201.17 lakh crore (provisional), govt told Rajya Sabha

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The country’s debt-to-GDP ratio has moderated to 58.2 per cent (provisional) in FY26 as against 58.5 per cent in the previous financial year, Parliament was informed on Tuesday.

As of March 31, 2026, the total debt of the Centre stood at Rs 201.17 lakh crore (provisional), Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary said in a written reply to the Rajya Sabha.

Post-Covid, the ratio of debt service (interest payment) to revenue receipts has broadly declined from 41.6 per cent in 2020-21 to 37.6 per cent in 2025-26 (provisional), being indicative of the government’s ability to finance requirements of debt servicing through revenue receipts, he said.

It may also be mentioned that in BE 2026-27, the effective capital expenditure of Rs 17.15 lakh crore is higher than fresh debt receipts (fiscal deficit) of Rs 16.96 lakh crore of the government, he said.

This implies that borrowings are entirely used for creation of assets, he said.

Replying to a question by Independent member Dilip Kumar Ray, the minister said



‘It may also be mentioned that in BE 2026-27, the effective capex of Rs 17.15 lakh cr is higher than fresh debt receipts (fiscal deficit) of Rs 16.96 lakh cr of the govt’

the debt burden of the Union government is projected at Rs 228.27 lakh crore in FY27 as against Rs 211.06 lakh crore in FY26.

Liabilities as per the FRBM definition of debt are net of cash balance and cash investment.

Replying to another question, Chaudhary said the central government’s capital expenditure during FY21-FY26 was Rs 44.03 lakh crore.

The increase in capital expenditure as a percentage of GDP has led to an increase in infrastructure development,

including roads, railways, urban infrastructure, energy and digital connectivity, he said.

The increased capex has led to improved logistics efficiency, generated employment and crowded-in private investment, he said.

The government continues to prioritise effective capital expenditure through budgetary allocation towards infrastructure and support states and UTs through the Scheme for Special Assistance to States for Capital Investment (SASCI) to incentivise capital expenditure, he said.

HIGHLIGHTS

» Post-Covid, the ratio of debt service (interest payment) to revenue receipts has broadly declined from 41.6% in 2020-21 to 37.6% in 2025-26 (provisional)

» ‘Debt burden of Union govt is projected at Rs 228.27 lakh cr in FY27 as against Rs 211.06 lakh cr in FY26’

» ‘The capital expenditure of central government during FY21-FY26 was Rs 44.03 lakh crore’

ture, he said.

The government’s steps to accelerate effective capital outlay in the coming years include focus on initiatives such as the PM GatiShakti National Master Plan, the National Logistics Policy, and the PM GatiShakti Public Platform, he said.

These have strengthened integrated planning, inter-agency coordination and technology-enabled project implementation, thereby enhancing the efficiency and quality of infrastructure development, he added.

PSU OMCs spend over ₹1.72 lakh crore on ethanol procurement across 3 ESYs: Govt

‘PSU OMCs procure fuel-grade ethanol from domestic sugarcane- and grain-based feedstocks under the Ethanol Blended Petrol (EBP) Programme’

NEW DELHI: Public Sector Oil Marketing Companies (OMCs) spent Rs 48,757 crore on ethanol procurement during Ethanol Supply Year (ESY) 2023-24, Rs 73,996 crore during ESY 2024-25 and Rs 49,577 crore up to June in ESY 2025-26, the government informed Parliament on Monday.

In a written reply in the Rajya Sabha, Minister of State for Petroleum and Natural Gas Suresh Gopi said PSU OMCs procure fuel-grade ethanol from domestic sugarcane- and grain-based feedstocks under the Ethanol Blended Petrol (EBP) Programme.

“OMCs procure ethanol from domestic sources, including sugarcane-based feedstocks such as C-heavy and B-heavy molasses, sugarcane juice and sugar syrup, as well as grain-based feedstocks including damaged foodgrains, surplus rice with the Food Corporation of India (FCI) and maize,” the minister said.

The minister further informed that as of July 16, 2026, PSU OMCs had registered 501 ethanol manufacturing units for the supply of denatured anhydrous ethanol under the Ethanol Blended Petrol Programme.

“As on 16.07.2026, Public Sector Oil Marketing Companies (OMCs) have registered 501 ethanol manufacturing units for supply of denatured



Minister of State for Petroleum and Natural Gas Suresh Gopi further informed that as of July 16, 2026, PSU OMCs had registered 501 ethanol manufacturing units for the supply of denatured anhydrous ethanol under the Ethanol Blended Petrol Programme

anhydrous ethanol under the Ethanol Blended Petrol (EBP) Programme,” Gopi said in the written reply.

According to the reply, Indian Oil Corporation Ltd (IOCL), Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL) and Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd (HPCL), through its subsidiary HPCL Biofuels Ltd, are also engaged in the production of fuel-grade ethanol.

IOCL has an installed pro-

duction capacity of 228 kilolitres per day and produced 712 kilolitres in ESY 2025-26 up to June 30. BPCL has an installed capacity of 200 kilolitres per day and produced 76 kilolitres, while HPCL Biofuels has an installed capacity of 120 kilolitres per day and produced 9,373 kilolitres during the period.

The reply also showed that Uttar Pradesh recorded the highest sale of ethanol-blended

KEY POINTS

» IOCL, BPCL and HPCL, through its subsidiary HPCL Biofuels Ltd, are also engaged in the production of fuel-grade ethanol

» IOCL has an installed production capacity of 228 kilolitres/day and produced 712 kilolitres in ESY26 till June 30

» BPCL has an installed capacity of 200 kilolitres per day and produced 76 kilolitres

» HPCL Biofuels has an installed capacity of 120 kilolitres per day and produced 9,373 kilolitres during the period

petrol by PSU OMCs at 124.98 crore litres during ESY 2024-25, followed by Maharashtra at 110.66 crore litres, Tamil Nadu at 92.18 crore litres, Karnataka at 79.24 crore litres and Gujarat at 56.29 crore litres.

The government said the registered supplier base and domestic procurement network continue to support the implementation of the Ethanol Blended Petrol Programme across the country.

Adani-Total Gas posts Q1 profit of ₹133 crore

NEW DELHI: Adani Total Gas Ltd on Tuesday reported net profit of Rs 133 crore in April-June — the first quarter of the current 2026-27 fiscal — against Rs 162 crore earning in the same period a year back, the company said in a statement.

The company’s revenue was up 27 per cent at Rs 1,910 crore on account of higher volumes

of CNG. The cost of natural gas, which is turned into CNG to run automobiles and piped to household kitchens for cooking, rose 39 per cent to Rs 1,454 crore.

“Higher gas cost due to continued West Asia crisis, and increase in APM gas price ceiling, the cost of natural gas rose 39 per cent,” the statement said.

“During the quarter, APM

allocation for CNG segment reduced to 30 per cent from 36 per cent from the last quarter, the balance was met with existing contracts and higher priced spot procurement.”

ATGL said it took a calibrated approach in passing the higher gas cost to ensure volume growth does not get impacted.

CNG volume increased 18

per cent year-on-year while piped natural gas (PNG) connections rose to 11.41 lakhs.

“Despite the geopolitical headwinds in West Asia, PNG volumes grew by 4 per cent year-on-year, supported by strong growth in the domestic and commercial volumes,” the statement said. “Overall volume has increased by 13 per cent.”

AGENCIES

Adani Energy Solutions posts Q1 profit of ₹1,237 cr

NEW DELHI: Adani Energy Solutions on Tuesday posted a more than twofold rise in consolidated net profit to Rs 1,236.56 crore in the April-June quarter compared to the year-ago period on higher revenues.

The consolidated net profit stood at Rs 538.94 crore in the quarter ended on June 30, 2025, an exchange filing showed.

Total income rose to Rs 9,852.20 crore in the quarter

from Rs 7,025.49 crore in the same period a year ago.

Revenue from the transmission business rose to Rs 3,335.26 crore from Rs 2,188.19 crore a year ago. The revenue from the distribution business increased to Rs 3,520.43 crore from Rs 3,359.84 crore a year ago.

The Energy Solutions Platform segment grew to Rs 1,906.83 crore in the quarter from Rs 209.71 crore a year ago.

Smart meter business also expanded to Rs 346.99 crore in the quarter from Rs 112 crore a year ago.

“AESL has delivered a robust start to FY27, driven by strong financial performance and continued operational excellence across our core businesses. During the quarter, we further strengthened our growth platform through the proposed acquisition of IntelliSmart, a

strategic step towards building India’s leading smart metering platform,” said Kandarp Patel, CEO, Adani Energy Solutions, in a statement.

He added that the Energy Solutions Platform has now gathered momentum, supported by significant renewable energy tie-ups and growing consumer stack across utilities, Commercial & Industrial and data centre segments.

PTI

Sport

Mad(rid) scenes

Spain’s world champions return to royal welcome and parade in front of huge crowd

MADRID: Spain’s World Cup-winning team returned home on Monday and an estimated crowd of almost 2 million was on hand to greet the squad through the streets of Madrid.

The 26 players and their coaching staff met with the country’s royals, and then with Prime Minister Pedro Sánchez, after arriving in the Spanish capital a day after beating Argentina 1-0 in the final in New Jersey.

“Thank you to the coaches and players for the style of play, the effort and the victory,” Sánchez said. “We have truly enjoyed watching you play.”

The squad then boarded an open-top bus for a raucous parade through central Madrid. “Stars shine together” was written on the bus, which also carried photos of the footballers.

Players — carrying the World Cup trophy and wearing shirts with the words Somos Campeones (We Are Champions) — danced and interacted with the fans along the route.

“It’s been an emotional and proud experience to represent a wonderful country with such passionate and devoted fans,” Spain coach Luis de la Fuente said before the parade started. “We are filled with joy.”

The squad traveled down Madrid’s historic avenues from



Spain’s players celebrate atop a bus during their trophy parade in Madrid on Monday

AP

near Moncloa Palace, the prime minister’s official residence, to Cibeles Square, where authorities told local media that some 120,000 people were on hand for a ceremony. Players were introduced one by one before entering the stage set up at the square. Each picked the song to be played when they came in. Álex Baena, celebrating his 25th birthday, entered with the World Cup trophy.

Coach De la Fuente was

thrust into the air by his players after being introduced. The coach was among those who sang along to the song being played for them.

Striker Borja Iglesias featured as a D.J. at one point, with his teammates dancing on the stage.

Singers Aitana, Ana Mena and Lola Índigo were among those entertaining the crowd and the players.

The ceremony ended with

the whole Spain squad lifting the trophy again, just like at the awards ceremony on Sunday, but now in front of the local crowd. Groups of fans had begun securing their spots near Cibeles late Monday morning ahead of the team’s arrival, bringing umbrellas to protect against the sun and temperatures of up to 35 Celsius (95 Fahrenheit). The square is where previous Spain teams and their supporters have typ-

“It’s been an emotional and proud experience to represent a wonderful country with such passionate and devoted fans” — Luis de la Fuente, Spain coach

ically gathered to celebrate. It’s also the traditional celebration spot for Real Madrid when it wins titles. Officials estimated a total of 1.8 million people welcomed the team in Madrid.

Spain walked off with the trophy Sunday after Ferran Torres scored the winner in extra time to secure its second World Cup title — and first since 2010 in South Africa.

The team was congratulated by the leaders of the three countries that co-hosted the tournament — U.S. President Donald Trump, Mexican President Claudia Sheinbaum and Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney. After the final whistle, Madrid erupted into celebrations, with thousands pouring into the streets from bars and restaurants.

AGENCIES

INFANTINO EFFUSIVE IN PRAISE OF HOSTS Bigger World Cup delivered more hits than misses

NEW YORK: There are a lot of things that could have gone wrong during this summer’s World Cup — a complicated logistical undertaking that included three host nations, 16 stadiums, 48 teams, 104 games and endless opportunities for controversy on and off the soccer field. But in retrospect, a lot of things went right.

The United States, Canada and Mexico spent nearly six weeks hosting soccer’s biggest showcase and — at least for the most part — the action stayed on the field. Star players like Argentina’s Lionel Messi, France’s Kylian Mbappé and Norway’s Erling Haaland became household names across North America, television ratings remained high in the US even after the Americans were eliminated and despite high ticket prices, most games featured packed stadiums.

FIFA President Gianni Infantino gave effusive praise to the host countries on Sunday.

Attendance was good Fox broadcast all 104 games in English on its platforms and American viewership remained strong even after the US was eliminated by Belgium in the round of 16.

Spanish broadcasts on Tel-



A view of the MetLife stadium during the closing ceremony

AP

option — even for non-native speakers.

Fox hasn’t yet released its viewership numbers for Sunday’s final, but Telemundo’s preliminary numbers show the Spain-Argentina matchup had a total audience of 22.6 million, putting it on track to become the most-watched World Cup final in Spanish-language media history.

The weather cooperated Fans and players from other countries found out what Americans, Canadians and Mexicans have known for a long time — it can get pretty hot here in the summer. Climate change isn’t helping matters. But Mother Nature could have been a lot meaner than she decided to be.

Even so, there were a handful of games that featured

particularly hot and muggy conditions. The best example was a knockout-round game between Paraguay and France on July 4 in Philadelphia when temperatures hovered around 100 degrees Fahrenheit (38 Celsius).

Size doesn’t matter This year’s 48-team World Cup field was the biggest in the tournament’s history and many thought it would water down the competition. That wasn’t the case. Cape Verde held eventual champion Spain to a draw in its opening game, advanced to the round of 32 and gave Argentina a scare before losing 3-2 in extra time in a World Cup classic. Congo also advanced beyond the group stage and pushed England before eventually losing.

AGENCIES

‘Our contingent is well-prepared’: Glasgow set, India ready for Commonwealth challenge

S KANNAN

GLASGOW: With less than 48 hours to go for the opening ceremony of the 2026 Commonwealth Games at the OVO Hydro, Glasgow still appears as ‘sleepy’ for first-time visitors. Compared to the usual buzz of a city like London, this place is more calm, more soothing. Unusual, though, is an extremely sunny day and temperature rising.

The air quality in the city is a dream, with plenty of controls in place to keep the emission levels even lower. Surely, for athletes from India who will take part in the 10 disciplines from July 23 to August 2, the weather, mood and ambience is perfect. Glasgow has hosted the CWG before, in 2014. There has been a cut in the number of disciplines, due to efforts needed to cap costs. However, this is one-off, as Amdavad will

host the next edition in 2030, on a lavish scale.

From Neeraj Chopra to Mirabai Chanu and Lovlina Borgohain to more track and field stars and boxers, the mood in the Indian camp is upbeat. Neeraj had missed the last edition of the CWG in 2022 in Birmingham due to an injury. This time, he is keen to do well, having recovered from a back injury. As for Mirabai and Lovlina, they will be doing the hon-



ours at the opening ceremony as flag and baton bearer.

Speaking to **Millennium Post**, Indian Olympic Association President PT Usha said:

“Our contingent is well-prepared for the CWG, and I am happy with arrangements for the Games in Glasgow.”

“Preparations have been top-class and all 126 athletes who will compete under the India flag will do so with fervour and sincerity. The next edition of the CWG will be held in Amdavad (Ahmedabad), so there is a lot for us, the athletes and administrators to learn from Glasgow,” said Usha.

The IOA President has visited Glasgow a few times before as well. “In any multi-discipline Games, the opening ceremony sets the tone and tenor. I am sure all our athletes will peak in Glasgow and carry back wonderful memories. For me as the IOA President, the athletes come first,” added Usha.

Sports minister Dr Manukh Mandaviya also landed in Glasgow on Tuesday and will be taking part in an important

meeting on Wednesday — 12th Commonwealth Sports Ministers Meeting. The theme for the meeting is : “Reimagining the power of sport towards healthier, fairer and equitable Commonwealth communities.”

Several ministers from the Commonwealth countries will be taking part in the meeting, but Dr Mandaviya’s presence is important, as Amdavad is the next host city. The Sports Minister has time and again spo-

ken emphatically about how India will be a very big sports destination in coming years. His presence in Glasgow is welcomed by the Commonwealth Sports officials. There will be other key partners also present at the meeting where topics of importance like policy priorities, shared challenges and advance collaborative initiatives through sport ahead of the Commonwealth Heads of Government Meeting.



New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Main Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida, G.B. Nagar, (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tenders are invited from eligible contractors/firm for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in & <https://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

A) Fresh-Tender Work:

S. No.	Jobs No.	Name of the Work	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
1	61/GM/SM (WC-9)/ET /2026-27	D/o Village (C/o Toilet near Park on 24.00 mtr. wide road in Bakhtawarpur), Noida.	23.88

The above tenders can be uploaded from dated 22.07.2026 to 05.08.2026 up to 5:00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 06.08.2026 at 11:00 AM.

B) Re-Tender Work:

S. No.	Jobs No.	Name of the Work	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
2	17/GM/SM (WC-9)/ ET/2026-27	Regarding Construction of 01 No. Dog Shelter in Sector-93B for smooth Maintenance of biting/Aggressive and rabies infected Dogs in Accordance with the new guidelines given by the Hon'ble Supreme Court on 22.08.25 for street dogs, Noida.	29.10
3	18/GM/SM (WC-9)/ ET/2025-26	D/o Village (C/o Girls Toilet in Primary School and C/o Kitchen in Junior High School in Village Wazidpur) Noida.	11.69

The above tenders can be uploaded from dated 22.07.2026 to 28.07.2026 up to 5:00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 29.07.2026 at 11:00 AM.

General Manager (Civil)
Noida

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rohtash** (Mobile No.: 8375868397, 8929234743) S/o Shri Raju, R/o H.No. A-249, Lal Bagh, Azadpur, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **FIR No. 000163/2022 u/s 379/411 IPC at P.S. Roop Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Rohtash** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Rohtash** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **u/s 82 Cr.P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Rohtash** accused of **FIR No. 000163/2022 u/s 379/411 IPC at P.S. Roop Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **01.09.2026**.

By Order: Ms. Rashmi Raheja,
Judicial Magistrate, First Class-13 (Central),
Room No. 33, Ground Floor,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi.

DP/10039/N/2026

INDIAN RAILWAYS
GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS
(RAILWAY BOARD)
E-TENDER NO.2026RSI8741TC

Principal Executive Director, Railway Stores (S), Ministry of Railways, Railway Board, Government of India invites e-tender for procurement of 1,22,158 Nos. Upgraded Class'E' (6" x 11") Cartridge Tapered Roller Bearings used on Cast Steel Bogies (Narrow/Wide-Jaw of Freight Stock of Indian Railways for 22.9/25T Axle Load application through E-Reverse Auction.

2.0 The interested tenderers are advised to visit the website <http://ireps.gov.in> for details of the tender and submission of their e-bids.

3.0 No manual offers will be accepted against e-tender.

4.0 Tender will be closed at 15.00 hours on 24.08.2026.

5.0 Any corrigendum to this tender will be published on the website <http://ireps.gov.in> only and not in print media.

North Eastern Railway
Open Tender Notice No. : NER-BSB0SnT-OT-34-2026

"Open Tenders" through online (E-Tendering) are invited by Divisional Railway Manager (Signal & Telecom)/ Varanasi/N.E. Railway for and behalf of the President of India for the following works:

S.N. : 1. Tender Notice No. and Description of Work : **NER-BSB0SnT-OT-34-2026 : Name of Work : Provision of coach guidance system at Aurhar In. station of Varanasi Division, Approx. Value: ₹3,28,49,362.47, Earnest Money: ₹ 6,57,000.00, Cost of Tender Form : Rs. 00.00, Completion Period: 180 Days, Tender Closing Date & Time : 14.08.2026 upto 15:00Hrs.**

1. Tender Online will be submitted up to 15:00 Hrs. on date 14.08.2026. 2. For full details and submission of bid kindly visit the official website of Indian Railways i.e. www.ireps.gov.in.

Divl. Rly. Manager (S&T)
CPRO-Sig-70
N.E. Railway, Varanasi
Do not travel with inflammable article in train

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Tender Notice No. 5420262027/119
Dated: 20.07.2026
CORRIGENDUM

Sub: Cancellation of Publication of Tender Notice No. 5420262027 of Tender No. 119 dated 15.07.2026

SIN -/ NIT No. & Tender No.: 5420262027-119 / Name of Work of IREPS Tender Published on NCR website: Combined tender-(A) DDU-PRYJ:- Improvement of RUB/LHS no.09, 14, 16, 25, 1C, 120C, 123C, 124C for protection from water seepage works under Sr.DENUPRVJ (B) CAP-CPU Improvement of RUB/LHS no. 9C, 14C, 20C, 21C, 22C, 120A, 85B for protection from water seepage and other miscellaneous works under ADEN/CAR. Reason: Administrative ground. Due to administrative reasons related to Tender No. 119 on the NCR website, the above-mentioned tender is required to be cancelled. The tender has not been published on IREPS. All other conditions will be remained same. **163226(K)**

www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in 

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:-

Name of Work with its location	Part-C: Replacement of number plates, provision of caution boards, sigma boards, neutral section boards and other reliability activities like tree trimming & muf raising in DUK section inconnection with Strengthening of existing TRD assets in DUK section.
Approx. Cost of work	₹2,26,81,003.66
Earnest Money deposit	₹4,53,600/-
E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period	30.07.2026 (00:00 hrs.) to 13.08.2026 (15:00 hrs.)
E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	13.08.2026 (15:00 hrs.)
Website particulars where complete details of tender document can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in
E-Tender No.:	18A-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated : 20.07.2026 2504/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
SEE SECTION 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURKSHA SANHITA

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused Persons Namley **1.Salman 2.Md. Imran S/o Md. Rafiq A/Vegabond, Kasturba Niketan ke Samne MCD Office, Lajpat Nagar, Delhi**, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under e-FIR No. **80007023/2026 U/s 305/331(4)/317(2)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita.**, has been registered at **PS: Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **1.Salman 2.Md. Imran** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **1.Salman 2.Md. Imran** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused said, **1.Salman 2.Md. Imran** of e-FIR No. **80007023/2026 U/s 305/331(4)/317(2)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita.**, has been registered at **PS: Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.08.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Manuj Kaushal
Ld. JMFC-03, Room No. 512
Saket Court, New Delhi

DP/10049/SE/2026
(Court Notice)

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय, रॉकी सर्वसाधारण के लिए सूचना



नाम-सावधानी अंगरिया, उम्र-13 वर्ष, उंचाई-4 फिट 3 इंच, रंग-साँवला, उपरोक्त लापता लड़की सावधानी अंगरिया, उम्र-13 वर्ष, पिता-बसिल अंगरिया, ग्राम-पटनिया, पो-पोशेता, थाना-गोईलकरा, जिला-परिचम सिंधूम जो दिनांक-03.04.2026 से लापता है जो आजतक अपने घर वापस नहीं आई है। जिसके संबंध में लालपुर थाना काण्ड सं-140/2026, दिनांक-07.07.2026, धारा-137(2) भा०न्यासं० दर्ज कर इनकी खोजबीन की जा रही है। उपरोक्त सूचना को सार्वजनिक किया जाना आवश्यक है।

अतः सभी जनसाधारण से अनुरोध है कि यदि उपरोक्त लापता लड़की कहीं मिलती / दिखती है तो इसके संबंध में वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक के कार्यालय में या निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर संपर्क कर इसकी सूचना दें।

Email ID(mc-dcb@jhpolicenoida.gov.in)
पुलिस उपाधीक्षक, नगर, रॉकी। -9431706137
थाना प्रमारी, लालपुर, रॉकी। -9431706159
आवेदक मसीह अंगरिया। -6353899099

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक,
रॉकी

PR 385426 (Police)26-27"D



Government of India
Ministry of Health and Family Welfare National Commission for Allied and Healthcare Professions (NCAHP)

PUBLIC NOTICE

The draft of curriculum of Diploma in Medical Radiology and Imaging Technology is placed in public domain through National Commission for Allied and Healthcare Professions (NCAHP) inviting comments from public in general, experts, stakeholders and organisations etc.

2. Objections, suggestions/comments, if any, on the above draft curriculum may be furnished in the google form link as provided adjacent to the draft curriculum on the website (<https://ncahp.abdm.gov.in>) within thirty (30) days from the date of uploading on the website (upto 17.08.2026).

Sd/-
Secretary, NCAHP

CBC 17225/11/0002/2627



UJVN Limited
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No.U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website: www.ujvnl.com

Tender Notice

Office of the Executive Engineer (I&P-I), UJVN Limited, "Ujjwal", Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun, invites sealed bid from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

Tender No.: 01/EE(I&P-I)/Dehradun/2026-27

Name of work : Providing Manpower for the various I&P offices functional under General Manager(CDH-NP) at Dehradun.

Estimated cost : Rs.53,164.00(GST extra)

Date of availability of bid document on website: From 17:00 hrs of 22.07.2026

Last date for submission of bid: Upto 15:00 hrs of 17.08.2026

For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website, the tender document can be downloaded from the Nigam's website www.ujvnl.com

Executive Engineer (I&P-I)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused persons Namely (1) **Kamal (2) Mithlesh S/o Roop Singh (3) Roop Singh S/o Ala Singh R/o C-2/1586, Sector-27, Rohini, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 534/2020 U/s 323/341/34 IPC PS: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused (1) **Kamal (2) Mithlesh (3) Roop Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused (1) **Kamal (2) Mithlesh (3) Roop Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said (1) **Kamal (2) Mithlesh (3) Roop Singh** accused of **FIR No. 534/2020 U/s 323/341/34 IPC PS: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi.** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
JMFC-05, Room No. 114
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/9808/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Lalit S/o Late Sh. Madan R/o H.No. 411, Gali Hotel wali, Kabir Basti, Malka Ganj, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **FIR No. 59/2019 u/s 323/341/506/34 IPC at P.S. Subzi Mandi, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Lalit** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Lalit** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **u/s 82 Cr.P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Lalit** accused of **FIR No. 59/2019 u/s 323/341/506/34 IPC at P.S. Subzi Mandi, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **21.09.2026**.

By Order: Ms. Preeti Rajoriya,
Judicial Magistrate, First Class-07 (Central),
Room No. 32,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi.

DP/9910/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused persons (1) **Fahad Khan @ Babar S/o Rafatullah Khan (2) Mohd. Yasir S/o Rafatullah Khan R/o H.No. 4/1037, Gali No.-15, House of Sariful Hasan, Jeevagarh Civil Line Near Dr. Vikhar Ahmad Clinic, Aligarh (U.P.), Also at: F-42, 3rd Floor, Shaheen Bagh, Okhla, New Delhi**, have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 327/2013, U/s 336/201/395/397/307/412/34 IPC, PS Kotla Mubarkpur, South Distt., New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused persons cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused persons have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that (1) **Fahad Khan @ Babar (2) Mohd. Yasir** the said accused of **FIR No. 327/2013, U/s 336/201/395/397/307/412/34 IPC, PS Kotla Mubarkpur, South Distt., New Delhi**, are required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Shivani Chauhan
Additional Sessions Judge, South-East,
Room No.-613, (Fast Track Court)-01,
Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/9948/SD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused persons Namely **Mukesh @ Lingu S/o Chaman Lal R/o H. No.159, Ambekar Park Wali Gali, Nehru Kutia, Malka Ganj, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 130/2020 U/s 380/411 IPC PS: Subzi Mandi, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mukesh @ Lingu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mukesh @ Lingu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mukesh @ Lingu** accused of **FIR No. 130/2020 U/s 380/411 IPC PS: Subzi Mandi, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Preeti Rajoria
JMFC-07, Room No. 32
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/9913/N/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Subhash @ Chandra Bose S/o Sikandara Paswan R/o E-7/199, Sultampur, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 517/2025, U/S 137(2)/64(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 & 6 PCOSO Act, PS Raj Park, Outer Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Subhash @ Chandra Bose** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Subhash @ Chandra Bose** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **Subhash @ Chandra Bose** the said accused of **FIR No. 517/2025, U/S 137(2)/64(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 & 6 PCOSO Act, PS Raj Park, Outer Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Neeti Suri Mishra
Additional Sessions Judge
(FSC)(PCOSO), North-East,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/9932/OD/2026
(Court Matter)



ASSETS CARE & RECONSTRUCTION ENTERPRISE LTD.
Corporate Office : Unit No. 502, C Wing, ONE BKC, Plot No. C - 66, G - Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Mumbai - 400051.
Tel: 022 68643101.
Registered Office : 14th Floor, EROS Corporate Tower, Nehru Place, New Delhi - 110019.
E-mail : acre.arc@acredia.in | Website : www.acredia.in | CIN : U65993DL2002PLC115769

APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(b) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to **Assets Care & Reconstruction Enterprise Ltd. [CIN : U65993DL2002PLC115769] ("Secured Creditor")**, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 10.08.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M., for recovery of Rs. 83,63,677/- (Rupees Eighty Three Lakh Sixty Three Thousand Six Hundred Seventy Seven only) pending towards Loan Account No. HHLNOD00222510, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 09.07.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. **10.07.2026** along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from **VIJAY GROVER** and **REENA GROVER**.

The Loan Account bearing No. HHLNOD00222510, along with all right(s), title(s), interest(s), underlying security(ies), pledge(s) and / or guarantee(s), including the Immovable Property, had been assigned by Sammaan Capital Limited ("SCL") (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) to Indiabulls Asset Reconstruction Co. Ltd. ("IARCL") vide Assignment Agreement dated 31.12.2018 and the same had been renounced by IARCL and bears new Loan Account No. V0040IV-02. The said Loan Account had been further assigned by IARCL to and in favour of the Secured Creditor, acting as a Trustee of ACRE - 102 - Trust vide Assignment Agreement dated 26.04.2021 read with Rectification Deed dated 26.08.2021. Furthermore, the said Loan Account has now been assigned by Assets Care & Reconstruction Enterprise Ltd. acting as a Trustee of ACRE - 180 - Trust vide Assignment Agreement dated 23.06.2025.

The Reserve Price for the Immovable Property will be Rs. 74,70,000/- (Rupees Seventy Four Lakh Seventy Thousand only) and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be Rs. 7,47,000/- (Rupees Seven Lakh Forty Seven Thousand only) i.e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

RESIDENTIAL APARTMENT NO. 81 - 1702, ON 17TH FLOOR, HAVING LEASABLE AREA / SALEABLE AREA OF 1765 SQUARE FEET APPROX., SITUATED AT COMPLEX KNOWN AS "JYG PALM COURT", CONSTRUCTED ON PLOT NO. GH-1-D, SECTOR - 16C, GREATER NOIDA, NOIDA - 201308, UTTAR PRADESH.

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.acredia.in; Contact No : 0124 - 6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id: auctionhelpline@sammaanacpial.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

SD/-
AUTHORIZED OFFICER
ASSETS CARE & RECONSTRUCTION ENTERPRISE LTD.
TRUSTEE OF ACRE - 180 - TRUST
Place : NOIDA

Date : 16.07.2026

"For any grievance you may contact Mr. Mohd Shariq Malik, Grievance Redressal Officer, Phone No. : 1800-209-2989, E-mail : complaint@acredia.in. The detailed policy on Grievance Redressal Mechanism within the organisation can be accessed at <https://www.acredia.in/compliance>".

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Kasim Ali S/o Lt. Fakir Mohd. R/o H.No. 533/B, Gali No.-12, Sangam Vihar, New Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 41/2017, U/S 498A/406/323/506/34 IPC, PS Govindpuri, South-East Distt., New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Kasim Ali** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Kasim Ali** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **Kasim Ali** the said accused of **FIR No. 41/2017, U/S 498A/406/323/506/34 IPC, PS Govindpuri, South-East Distt., New Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms Kanika Handa
Judicial Magistrate First Class
(Mahila Court)-02, Court No.-507,
South-East Distt., Saket Courts Complex, New Delhi

DP/9968/SE/2026
(Court Matter)



ASSETS CARE & RECONSTRUCTION ENTERPRISE LTD.
Corporate Office : Unit No. 502, C Wing, ONE BKC, Plot No. C - 66, G - Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Mumbai - 400051.
Tel: 022 68643101.
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Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to **Assets Care & Reconstruction Enterprise Ltd. [CIN : U65993DL2002PLC115769] ("Secured Creditor")**, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 10.08.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M., for recovery of Rs. 97,84,135/- (Rupees Ninety Seven Lakh Eighty Four Thousand One Hundred Thirty Five only) pending towards Loan Account No. HHLNOD00222202, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 07.07.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. **08.07.2026** along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from **VIJAY GROVER** and **REENA GROVER**.

The Loan Account bearing No. HHLNOD00222202, along with all right(s), title(s), interest(s), underlying security(ies), pledge(s) and / or guarantee(s), including the Immovable Property, had been assigned by Sammaan Capital Limited ("SCL") (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) to Indiabulls Asset Reconstruction Co. Ltd. ("IARCL") vide Assignment Agreement dated 31.12.2018 and the same had been renounced by IARCL and bears new Loan Account No. V0040IV-01. The said Loan Account had been further assigned by IARCL to and in favour of the Secured Creditor, acting as a Trustee of ACRE - 102 - Trust vide Assignment Agreement dated 26.04.2021 read with Rectification Deed dated 26.08.2021. Furthermore, the said Loan Account has now been assigned by Assets Care & Reconstruction Enterprise Ltd. acting as a Trustee of ACRE - 102 - Trust to and in favour of the Secured Creditor acting as Trustee of ACRE - 180 - Trust vide Assignment Agreement dated 23.06.2025.

The Reserve Price for the Immovable Property will be Rs. 71,00,000/- (Rupees Seventy One Lakh only) and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be Rs. 7,10,000/- (Rupees Seven Lakh Ten Thousand only); i.e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

RESIDENTIAL APARTMENT NO. 82 - 1604, ON 16TH FLOOR, HAVING LEASABLE AREA / SALEABLE AREA OF 1635 SQUARE FEET APPROX., SITUATED AT COMPLEX KNOWN AS "JYG PALM COURT", CONSTRUCTED ON PLOT NO. GH-1-D, SECTOR - 16C, GREATER NOIDA, NOIDA - 201308, UTTAR PRADESH.

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.acredia.in; Contact No : 0124 - 6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id: auctionhelpline@sammaanacpial.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

SD/-
AUTHORIZED OFFICER
ASSETS CARE & RECONSTRUCTION ENTERPRISE LTD.
TRUSTEE OF ACRE - 180 - TRUST
Place : NOIDA

Date : 16.07.2026

"For any grievance you may contact Mr. Mohd Shariq Malik, Grievance Redressal Officer, Phone No. : 1800-209-2989, E-mail : complaint@acredia.in. The detailed policy on Grievance Redressal Mechanism within the organisation can be accessed at <https://www.acredia.in/compliance>".



‘Didn’t want to do injustice’

Siddharth revealed why he almost said no to ‘Operation Safed Sagar’

Operation Safed Sagar’ is gearing up to tell a forgotten story from the Indian Air Force. Recently, the series’ trailer was released at an event and was attended by the real-life heroes and their families.

The ensemble cast includes Siddharth, Jimmy Shergill, Mihir Ahuja, Taaruk Raina, Arnav Bhasin, Abhay Verma, Dia Mirza and Prajakta Koli.

Siddharth, who plays officer Ajay Ahuja in the series, got emotional as he spoke about the inspiration behind his character.

“For ‘Operation Safed Sagar’, I was initially hesitant to play the part because there is a way heroes are depicted, specifically our martyrs. They are not here to defend or accept the portrayal, so I find it difficult. It is easier to play a fictional character,” said the actor.

He added, “Secondly, the moment you know someone is a martyr, we tend to make them a certain kind of person and heroes don’t look like heroes. They are heroes because of their actions. So, I was scared. I didn’t want to do injustice to somebody’s memory. So, it took a lot of discus-



The actor, who plays officer Ajay Ahuja in the series, got emotional as he spoke about the inspiration behind his character

sion with the makers about staying true to the integrity of a great man’s memory and a soldier’s story. I just asked if his wife, Alka Ahuja, allowed it.”

The ‘Netflix’ series, directed by Oni Sen and created by Abhijeet Singh Parmar and Kushal Srivastava, will begin streaming on August 7.

AGENCIES

‘Will SRK be relevant in 2045?’



Annu Kapoor disagreed that Shah Rukh Khan is the ‘last superstar’

More than a decade ago, when Shah Rukh Khan appeared on Anupam Kher’s talk show ‘Kuch Bhi Ho Sakta Hai’, he made a statement that has often resurfaced over the years. “Main modest hoon, but I’ll tell you honestly? I am the last of the stars,” he had said. While many have echoed that sentiment, his ‘Darr’ co-star Annu Kapoor doesn’t agree.

In a recent interview, Annu dismissed the idea that Shah Rukh would be the ‘last superstar’. “I don’t think so,” he said. Explaining his point, Annu told ‘Hindi Rush’, “For years, the media has been creating this narrative that a particular person is the last superstar. Similar things were said during Rajesh Khanna’s time. Looking back, nobody in this industry has come close to matching the kind of innings Amitabh Bachchan, Lata Mangeshkar and Asha Bhosle have had. It has become very difficult for anyone to sustain

Despite disagreeing with the ‘last superstar’ label, Annu had only good things to say about SRK as a person

such a long career.”

Without directly naming Shah Rukh Khan, Annu continued, “The actor you’re referring to started around 1992. That makes it about 34 years. If you subtract 34 from Amitabh Bachchan’s 53-year career, there are still 19 years left. Do you think it is possible for Shah Rukh Khan to remain equally relevant for another 19 years? I’m not taking his name on purpose. Will he still be relevant in 2045? I don’t think so.” He was quick to add, however, “But nobody can take away the fact that Shah Rukh Khan is the second-richest actor in the world.”

AGENCIES

TUSSHAR KAPOOR ON ‘JANADESH’

‘A serious political drama’

Tusshar Kapoor opened up about working with acclaimed filmmaker Prakash Jha in his upcoming political drama ‘Janadesh’.

While speaking exclusively to IANS a few weeks ago on completing 25 years in the film industry, he said that the project marked both his first collaboration with Prakash Jha and his first foray into the political drama genre.

“It is a very serious and hard-hitting film on the political scenario in our country, but it is a fictional story. It is about how

Tusshar Kapoor opened up about his first collaboration with Prakash Jha

we are as people today. It is the first time I am being directed by Prakash Jha and it is a very interesting character. It is with newcomers. It is also me doing a political film for the first time. So, it is something I am excited to bring in front of the audience,” shared Tusshar.

The primary cast of the drama also includes Shekhar Suman,

Rahul Bose, Pragati Srivastava, Ishwak Singh and others.

Prakash Jha has made a name for himself with his political dramas such as ‘Raajneeti’ (2010), ‘Chakravayuh’ (2012), ‘Aarakshan’ (2011), and ‘Satyagraha’ (2013). Coming to OTT, he is credited with the Bobby Deol-led crime drama series ‘Aashram’ (2020).

Meanwhile, Tusshar’s promising line also includes the eagerly awaited laughter ride, ‘Golmaal 5’, the latest instalment in the popular franchise by director Rohit Shetty.

AGENCIES



LOCARNO FILM FESTIVAL

James Gray to receive lifetime career award

Filmmaker James Gray, known for projects such as ‘The Yards’, ‘The Lost City of Z’ and ‘The Immigrant’, will be honoured with a lifetime career award at the Locarno Film Festival.

The award will be presented to Gray on August 9. The festival will also screen his latest film ‘Paper Tiger’, which revolves around brothers, an ex-cop (Adam Driver) and a hardworking engineer (Miles Teller), who pursue the American Dream by partnering with a waterfront cleanup venture tied to the Russian mafia.

His previous directorials, ‘We Own the Night’ and ‘Two



The award will be presented to the filmmaker on August 9

Lovers’, will also be screened at the festival, according to the entertainment news outlet ‘Variety’.

“Since winning the Silver Lion at Venice for ‘Little Odessa’ (1994) at age 25, James Gray has forged a sin-

gular career rooted, with piercing realism, in his upbringing in New York’s Russian-Jewish community. As he has established himself at the top tier of filmmakers in the United States,” read the festival’s statement.

It added, “Gray’s explorations of the often elusive promise of the American dream have, over the past decade, expanded into more varied thematic terrain - colonial exploration, space travel, racial prejudice - that reshaped the popular understanding of his work while remaining distinctively his own: ‘The Lost City of Z’ (2016) with Charlie Hunnam and Robert Pattinson, ‘Ad Astra’ (2019) with Brad Pitt and ‘Armageddon Time’ (2022) with Anthony Hopkins.”

Locarno artistic director Giona A Nazzaro said Gray is the ‘last great novelist of American cinema’.

PTI

YASH & TARA SUTARIA TURN UP THE HEAT IN NEW ‘TOXIC’ SONG

OUR CORRESPONDENT

As ‘Toxic: A Fairy Tale for Grown-Ups’ continues to unveil the many layers of its story, ‘Madhosh’ opens the next chapter, offering audiences a fresh glimpse into the world of Raya (Yash) and Rebecca (Tara Sutaria). While ‘Tabaahi’ showcased the intensity and all-consuming nature of Raya’s relationship with Kiara Advani’s character, ‘Madhosh’ explores the easy-going, carefree dynamic he shares with Tara’s Rebecca.

The song is filled with moments that effortlessly showcase the chemistry between Raya and Rebecca. From an unconventional proposal that perfectly captures their mischievous bond to candid laughs, quiet conversations and fleeting glances, ‘Madhosh’ paints the picture of two people completely at ease with one another. Their relationship is spontaneous, filled with warmth



and humour, offering audiences a side of Raya that feels refreshingly uninhibited.

Rich in striking visuals, effortless chemistry and moments that are sure to spark conversations, the track leaves audiences eager to discover how these

The song ‘Madhosh’ is filled with moments that effortlessly showcase the chemistry between Raya (Yash) and Rebecca (Tara)

intertwined stories unfold when ‘Toxic: A Fairy Tale for Grown-Ups’ arrives in cinemas.

Written, produced and headlined by Yash, ‘Toxic: A Fairy Tale for Grown-Ups’ is directed by Geetu Mohandas and produced by ‘KVN Productions’ and ‘Monster Mind Creations’. The film also stars Nayanthara, Kiara Advani, Rukmini Vasanth and Huma Qureshi in pivotal roles. Shot simultaneously in English and Kannada and dubbed into Hindi, Telugu, Tamil and Malayalam, ‘Toxic’ is set for a worldwide theatrical release on August 26, 2026.



Juyal added that he never thinks about his public image in such situations

‘I will protect till my death’

Raghav Juyal opened up about shielding Shehnaaz Gill from paparazzi

Raghav Juyal recently found himself at the centre of social media attention after a video from his birthday celebration went viral. The clip showed the actor shielding his close friend Shehnaaz Gill as she was mobbed by fans and paparazzi while leaving the venue. The moment quickly reignited long-standing speculation about the two dating, rumours that have persisted since they shared the screen in Salman Khan’s ‘Kisi Ka Bhai Kisi Ki Jaan’.

In a chat with ‘Pinkvilla’, Raghav opened up about the viral moment and explained why stepping in to protect Shehnaaz came naturally to him. He said, “My parents raised me to be a man. If you had been there with me or any woman and a group of men had pounced on her, I was brought up to throw a solid punch if needed. That’s how I’ve been raised. I can’t be that detached, urban guy who just stands by. I couldn’t do it. I will protect till my death, my friends, my family and any woman I’m with. Whether it’s you or any other woman, that’s simply my nature.”

He further reflected on the idea of masculinity and said, “If there’s such a thing as sacred feminine energy, there’s also sacred masculinity. Both need to exist in balance. My dance, my art and my fluidity reflect the sacred feminine. But when the situation demands it, the values my parents instilled in me - to protect,



to stand by my sister, my friends and to respect women - come to the fore.”

Juyal added that he never thinks about his public image in such situations, saying, “I can’t just watch if a woman is being harassed, no matter who she is. If something like that happens, I know how to handle it and I have no inhibitions about stepping in. In those moments, I don’t think about my star image or any public image.”

Meanwhile, Shehnaaz Gill also addressed the dating rumours in a recent conversation with ‘Pinkvilla’. While refusing to comment on her personal life, she described Raghav Juyal as a close friend and urged fans to support his upcoming film ‘Bhai Tera Star Hai’. When asked about the rumours, Shehnaaz said, “No personal questions, please,” making it clear that she didn’t wish to discuss her relationship status.

AGENCIES